Chapter 3: System Analysis and Design

3.1 Introduction

This chapter presents a comprehensive analysis and design of the WaitLess Digital Queue Management System. It details the functional and non-functional requirements, use case modelling, system architecture, data design, process flows, user interface design, and security design. The analysis is grounded in the actual implementation of the system, which has been built and verified against an 83-feature requirements traceability matrix.

The system was designed for Chinhoyi Provincial Hospital in Zimbabwe, with the goal of replacing manual queue management with a real-time, web-based solution that streamlines patient flow from registration through triage, service delivery, and completion.

3.2 Requirements Analysis

3.2.1 Functional Requirements

The functional requirements are organised by module, with each requirement assigned a unique identifier consistent with the project's amendments and traceability audit.

Module 1: Patient Registration

ID	Requirement	Priority	Status
1.1	The system shall allow staff to electronically register patients with demographics, national ID, phone, address, category, next of kin, chief complaint, department, and notification consent.	High	Complete
1.2	The system shall support returning-patient search by name, phone, national ID, patient number, previous ticket, or scanned QR code, and reuse existing records without duplication.	High	Complete
1.3	The system shall generate a unique, immutable queue token (e.g., OPD-205, LAB-206) consistent across print, phone, WhatsApp, and display board.	High	Complete
1.4	The system shall generate a QR patient card for self-service identification and reception lookup.	Medium	Partial

ID	Requirement	Priority	Status
1.5	The system shall classify patients by category: walk-in, referred, emergency, elderly, pregnant, child, disabled, and chronic-care.	Medium	Complete

Module 2: Patient Self-Service

ID	Requirement	Priority	Status
2.1	The system shall allow online pre-registration with arrival activation by reception staff.	Medium	Partial
2.2	The system shall provide a self-service kiosk for check-in by QR code scan or phone number lookup, collecting department and visit reason, and issuing a queue token.	High	Complete
2.3	The system shall provide a live patient queue-status tracking page showing token, department, position, patients ahead, ETA, progress, directions, and notification history.	High	Complete
2.4	The system shall provide a patient feedback form for satisfaction, cleanliness, communication, and wait-time feedback.	Low	Not Started

Module 3: Triage

ID	Requirement	Priority	Status
3.1	The system shall support digital triage assessment capturing chief complaint, symptoms, vitals (oxygen saturation, heart rate, blood pressure, temperature, respiratory rate), pain score, and severity.	High	Complete
3.2	The system shall classify patients into four priority levels: Red (Critical), Yellow (Serious), Green (Ambulant), and Black (Deceased).	High	Complete
3.3	The system shall automatically fast-track Red priority cases based on emergency vital thresholds and trigger escalation alerts.	High	Complete
3.4	The system shall generate reassessment alerts for Red and Yellow patients who have been waiting beyond defined thresholds.	High	Complete
3.5	The system shall allow authorised triage staff to manually override the priority assignment, recording the before/after priority and the staff actor.	High	Complete

Module 4: Queue Management

ID	Requirement	Priority	Status
4.1	The system shall automatically assign patients to a department queue after registration or triage.	High	Partial
4.2	The system shall maintain department-specific queues for OPD, Casualty/Triage, Pharmacy, Laboratory, Radiology, and OI Clinic.	High	Complete
4.3	The system shall call the next patient by priority (Red > Yellow > Green > Black), then by arrival time, within a selected department.	High	Complete
4.4	The system shall mark a called patient as missed if they do not present for service.	High	Complete
4.5	The system shall support fair recall of missed patients with configurable reinsertion rules.	Medium	Partial
4.6	The system shall support queue transfer of a patient to another department with patient notification.	High	Complete
4.7	The system shall calculate dynamic estimated waiting time based on historical service time and queue position.	Medium	Partial
4.8	The system shall detect and display queue bottlenecks based on department load and thresholds.	Medium	Partial

Module 5: Department Routing

ID	Requirement	Priority	Status
5.1	The system shall support automatic department routing based on chief complaint keyword matching.	Medium	Partial
5.2	The system shall support doctor-to-laboratory test order workflow with lifecycle states (ordered, sample-collected, in-progress, completed, result-ready).	Medium	Partial
5.3	The system shall support doctor-to-pharmacy prescription workflow with lifecycle states (prescribed, dispensing, ready, collected).	Medium	Partial
5.4	The system shall support OI Clinic service streams (ART, TB, viral load, counselling, screening).	Low	Not Started

Module 6: Staff Dashboard

ID	Requirement	Priority	Status
6.1	The system shall provide a live queue dashboard with real-time metrics, queue tables, patient actions, alerts, and automatic refresh.	High	Complete
6.2	The system shall provide department-scoped dashboards that filter data by staff department assignment.	Medium	Complete
6.3	The system shall provide an administrator dashboard with staff management, audit trail, queue overview, reports, and settings.	High	Complete
6.4	The system shall display operational alerts including critical metrics, reassessment alerts, and notification failures.	Medium	Partial

Module 7: Notifications

ID	Requirement	Priority	Status
7.1	The system shall send WhatsApp notifications for registration, turn readiness, call, missed turn, and transfer events.	High	Partial
7.2	The system shall support web push notifications.	Low	Not Started
7.3	The system shall provide automatic and manual notification retry with configurable retry delays and attempt limits.	High	Complete
7.4	The system shall maintain a notification delivery log with status, timestamps, provider message ID, and error details.	High	Complete
7.5	The system shall send a missed-turn notification when a called ticket is marked missed.	High	Complete

Module 8: Queue Display Screens

ID	Requirement	Priority	Status
8.1	The system shall provide a public waiting-area display board showing now-serving, waiting, and missed token numbers without patient names.	High	Complete
8.2	The system shall provide department-specific display boards accessible via URL with department query parameter.	Medium	Complete
8.3	The system shall support audio calling of token numbers.	Low	Not Started

Module 9: Reporting

ID	Requirement	Priority	Status
9.1	The system shall generate a daily report by department, service, gender, age, and triage priority.	Medium	Not Started
9.2	The system shall generate an average waiting time report by department with date filtering.	High	Complete
9.3	The system shall generate a department performance report with throughput, missed rate, and priority breakdown.	High	Complete
9.4	The system shall generate a no-show report with notification delivery correlation per missed ticket.	High	Complete
9.5	The system shall generate a triage report with triage rate, timing, outcomes, overrides, and trends.	High	Complete
9.6	The system shall support PDF, Excel, and CSV export of reports.	Low	Not Started

Module 10: Analytics

ID	Requirement	Priority	Status
10.1	The system shall provide peak-hours analysis of patient arrivals and service patterns.	Low	Not Started
10.2	The system shall provide queue-congestion prediction.	Low	Not Started
10.3	The system shall provide resource-allocation suggestions based on current load.	Low	Not Started

Module 11: Security and Access Control

ID	Requirement	Priority	Status
11.1	The system shall enforce role-based access control with roles: admin, reception, triage, and clinician.	High	Complete
11.2	The system shall provide secure individual login with bcrypt password hashing and action attribution.	High	Complete
11.3	The system shall maintain an immutable, hash-chained audit trail of all operational actions.	High	Complete
11.4	The system shall implement automatic idle logout with inactivity timeout.	Medium	Not Started

Module 12: Privacy and Confidentiality

ID	Requirement	Priority	Status
12.1	The system shall display anonymous token numbers on public displays, never patient names.	High	Complete
12.2	The system shall capture and honour notification consent preferences.	High	Complete
12.3	The system shall provide confidential OI mode with masked routing and restricted data views.	Low	Not Started

Module 13: Offline and Connectivity

ID	Requirement	Priority	Status
13.1	The system shall support local-network hosting within a hospital LAN.	Medium	Partial
13.2	The system shall maintain core queue operation without internet connectivity.	Medium	Partial
13.3	The system shall queue notifications for delivery when internet connectivity returns.	Medium	Partial
13.4	The system shall provide local form auto-save with IndexedDB draft recovery.	Low	Not Started

Module 14–21: Additional Modules

Additional modules covering Appointment Management, OI Clinic, Pharmacy, Laboratory/Radiology, Staff Management, Patient Experience, Global System Features, and AI/Smart Assistance are defined in the project amendments. Their current implementation status is documented in the traceability matrix (Section 3.2.3).

3.2.2 Non-Functional Requirements

ID	Category	Requirement
NFR-01	Performance	The system shall load the public queue board within 3 seconds on a standard hospital LAN connection.
NFR-02	Performance	The system shall deliver real-time queue updates to connected clients within 2 seconds of a state change via Server-Sent Events.
NFR-03	Performance	The frontend production build shall not exceed 3 MB uncompressed (current: 2.49 MB).

ID	Category	Requirement
NFR-04	Security	All passwords shall be hashed using bcrypt with a minimum cost factor of 12.
NFR-05	Security	Staff sessions shall expire after 8 hours of inactivity.
NFR-06	Security	The audit trail shall be tamper-evident using SHA-256 hash chaining.
NFR-07	Security	Public displays shall never expose patient names or personally identifiable information.
NFR-08	Usability	The system shall be usable on desktop, tablet, and mobile devices with responsive design.
NFR-09	Usability	The system shall use a consistent visual language with medical teal (#0F766E) as the primary brand colour.
NFR-10	Reliability	The system shall persist all queue state to the database, surviving server restarts without data loss.
NFR-11	Reliability	The system shall support dual-mode storage (MySQL or file-based JSON) for deployment flexibility.
NFR-12	Scalability	The system shall support concurrent connections from at least 50 staff and display board clients.
NFR-13	Maintainability	The system shall use a modular architecture with clear separation of concerns (controller, service, repository layers).
NFR-14	Maintainability	The system shall use a component-based frontend architecture with reusable UI components.
NFR-15	Compatibility	The system shall run on Node.js v18+ and modern browsers (Chrome, Firefox, Edge, Safari).

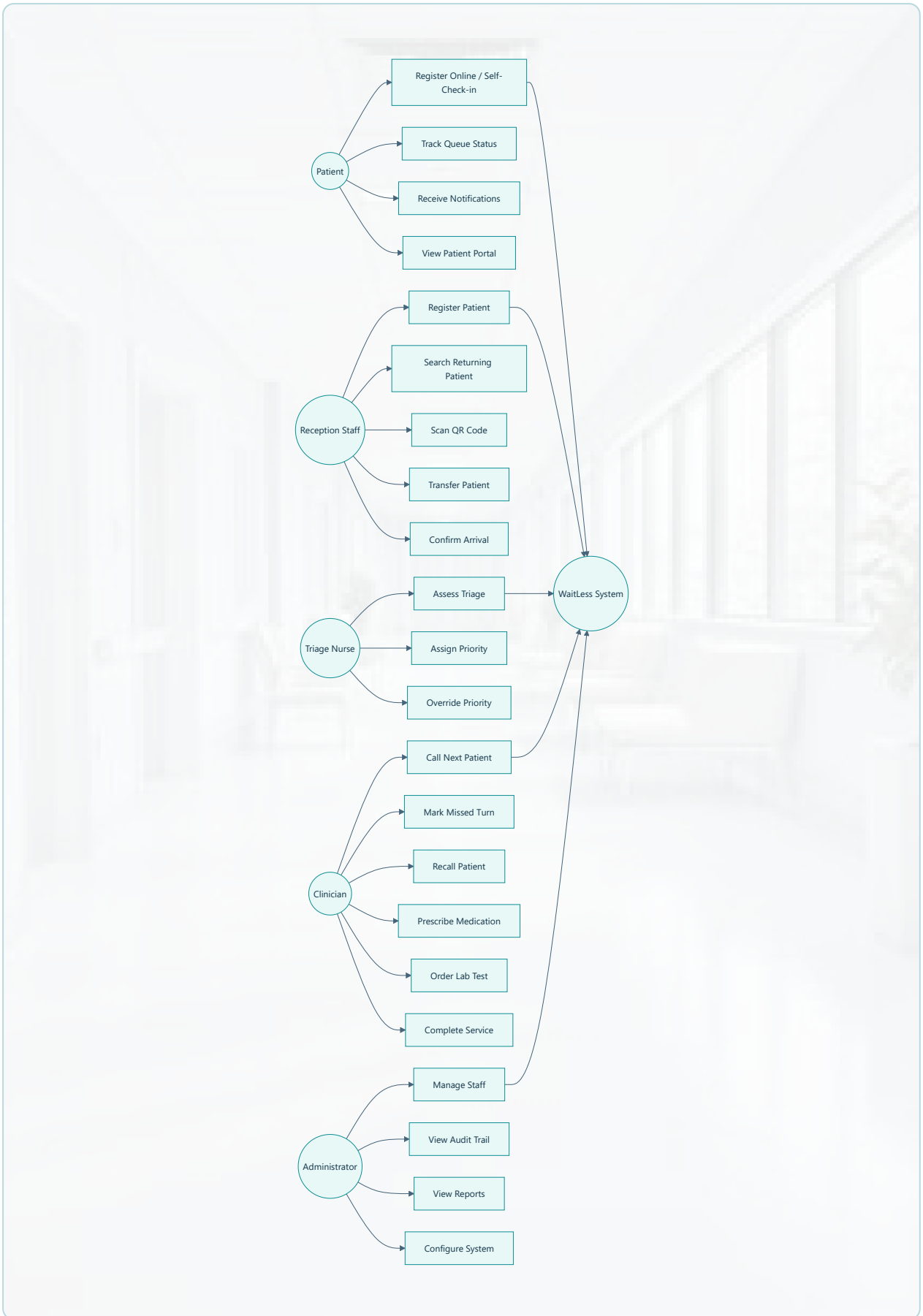
3.2.3 User Requirements by Stakeholder Role

Role	Key Requirements
Patient	Register online or at kiosk; receive a queue token; track queue status in real-time; receive WhatsApp notifications; view estimated wait time; leave and return without losing position.
Reception Staff	Register new and returning patients; search patient records; scan QR codes; manage queue tokens; transfer patients between departments; view department-scoped queue.

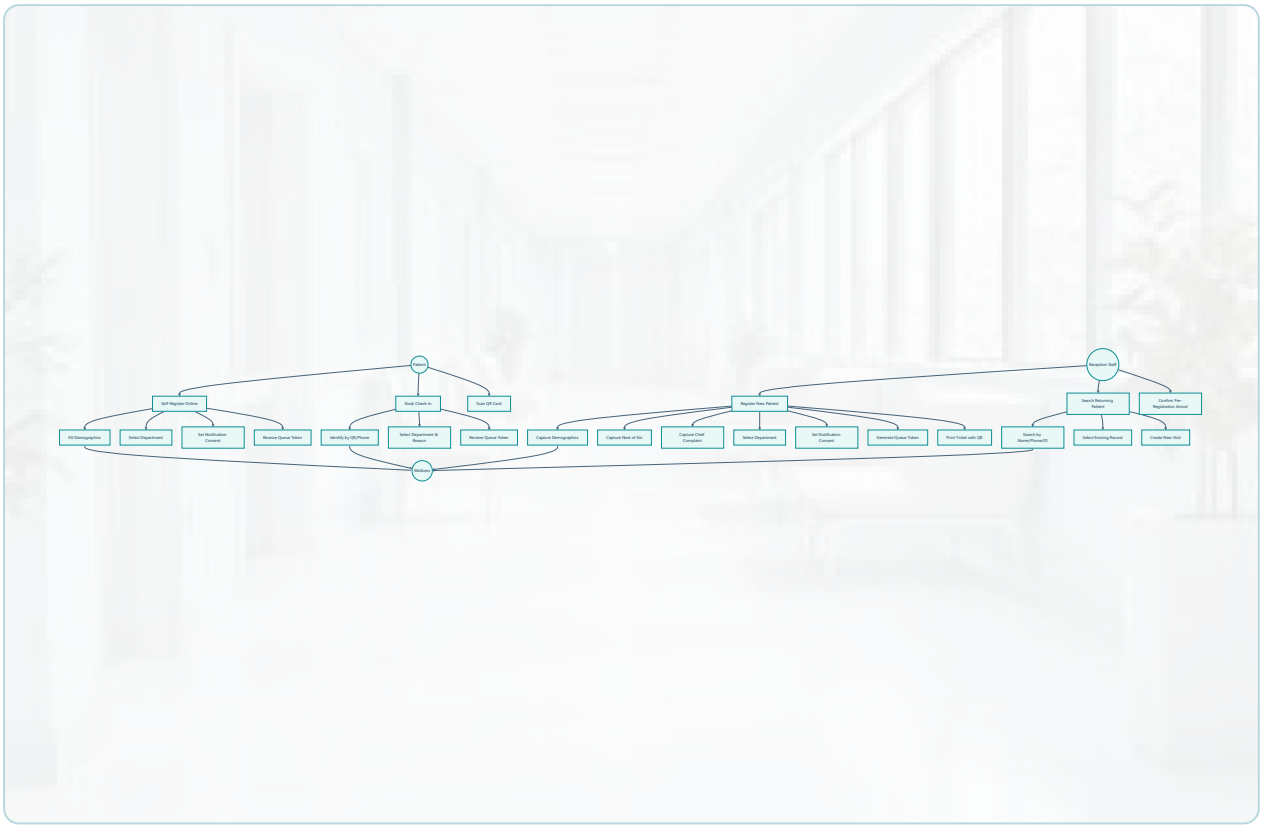
Role	Key Requirements
Triage Nurse	Conduct digital triage assessments; assign priority levels; override automatic classifications; view reassessment alerts; fast-track emergency cases.
Clinician/Doctor	Call next patient by priority; mark patients as in-service or completed; prescribe medications; order laboratory tests; transfer patients; view department dashboard.
Administrator	Manage staff accounts and roles; view system-wide audit trail; access all reports and analytics; configure system settings; manage departments.
Hospital Manager	View department performance reports; monitor waiting times and no-show rates; review triage outcomes; assess notification delivery effectiveness.

3.3 Use Case Diagrams

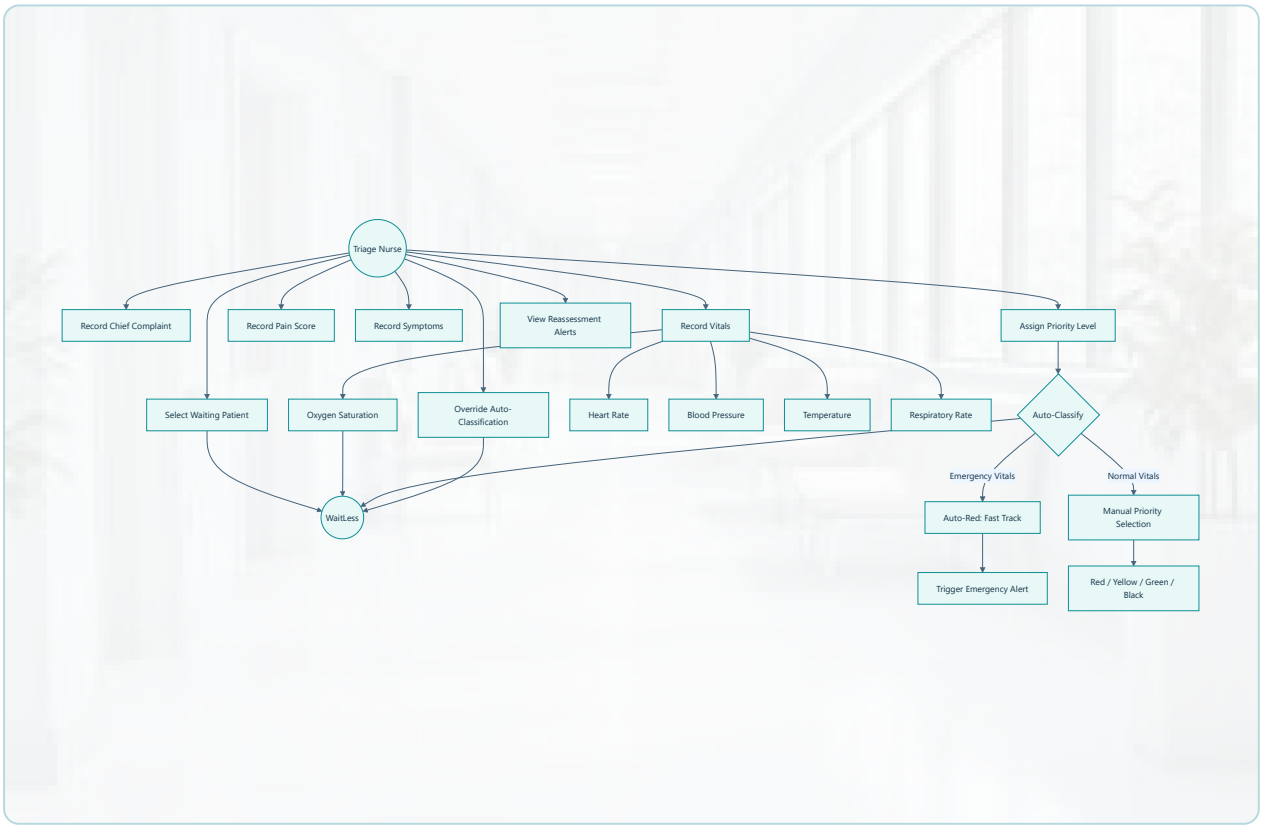
3.3.1 System-Wide Use Case Diagram


Patient
Register Online / Self-Check-in
Track Queue Status
Receive Notifications
View Patient Portal
Reception Staff
Register Patient
Search Returning Patient
Scan QR Code
Transfer Patient
Confirm Arrival
Triage Nurse
Assess Triage
Assign Priority
Override Priority
Clinician
Call Next Patient
Mark Missed Turn
Recall Patient
Prescribe Medication
Order Lab Test
Complete Service
Administrator
Manage Staff
View Audit Trail
View Reports
Configure System
WaitLess System

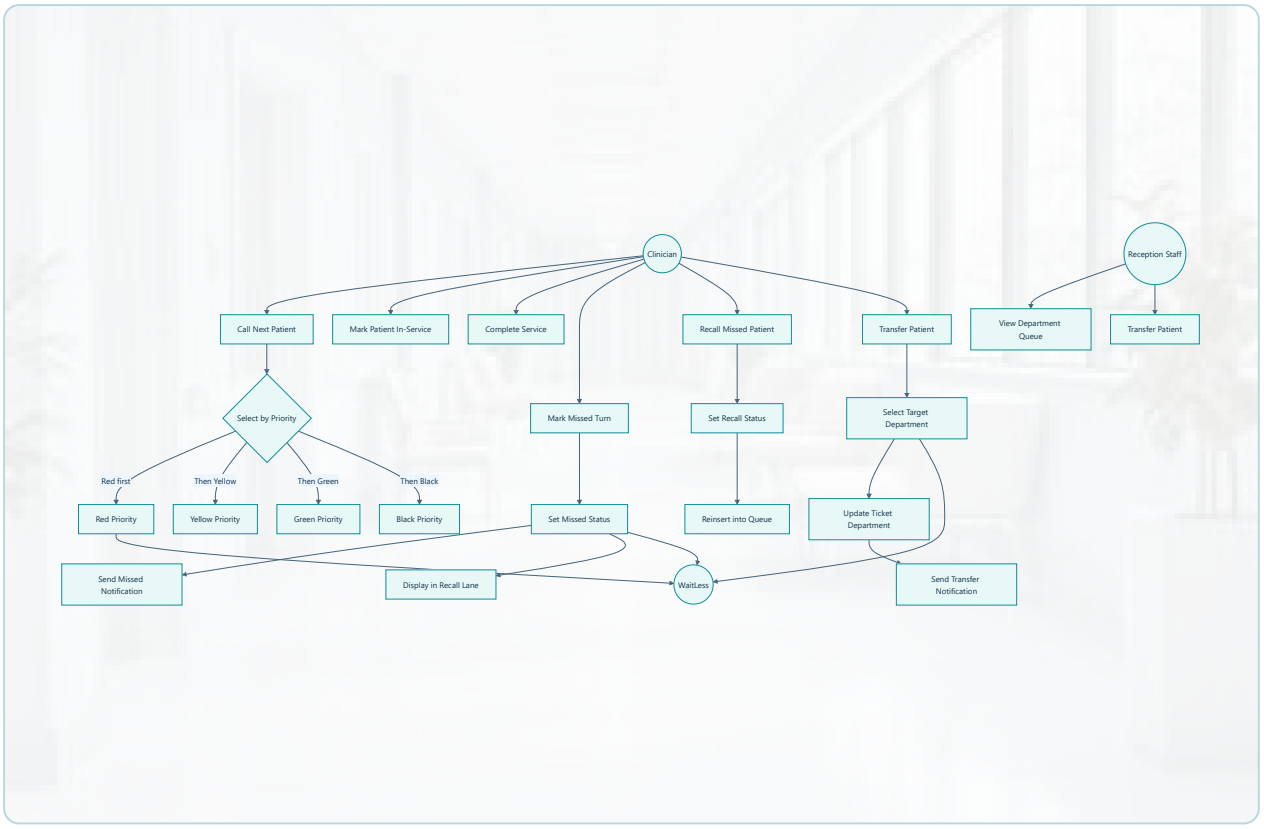
3.3.2 Patient Registration Use Case Diagram



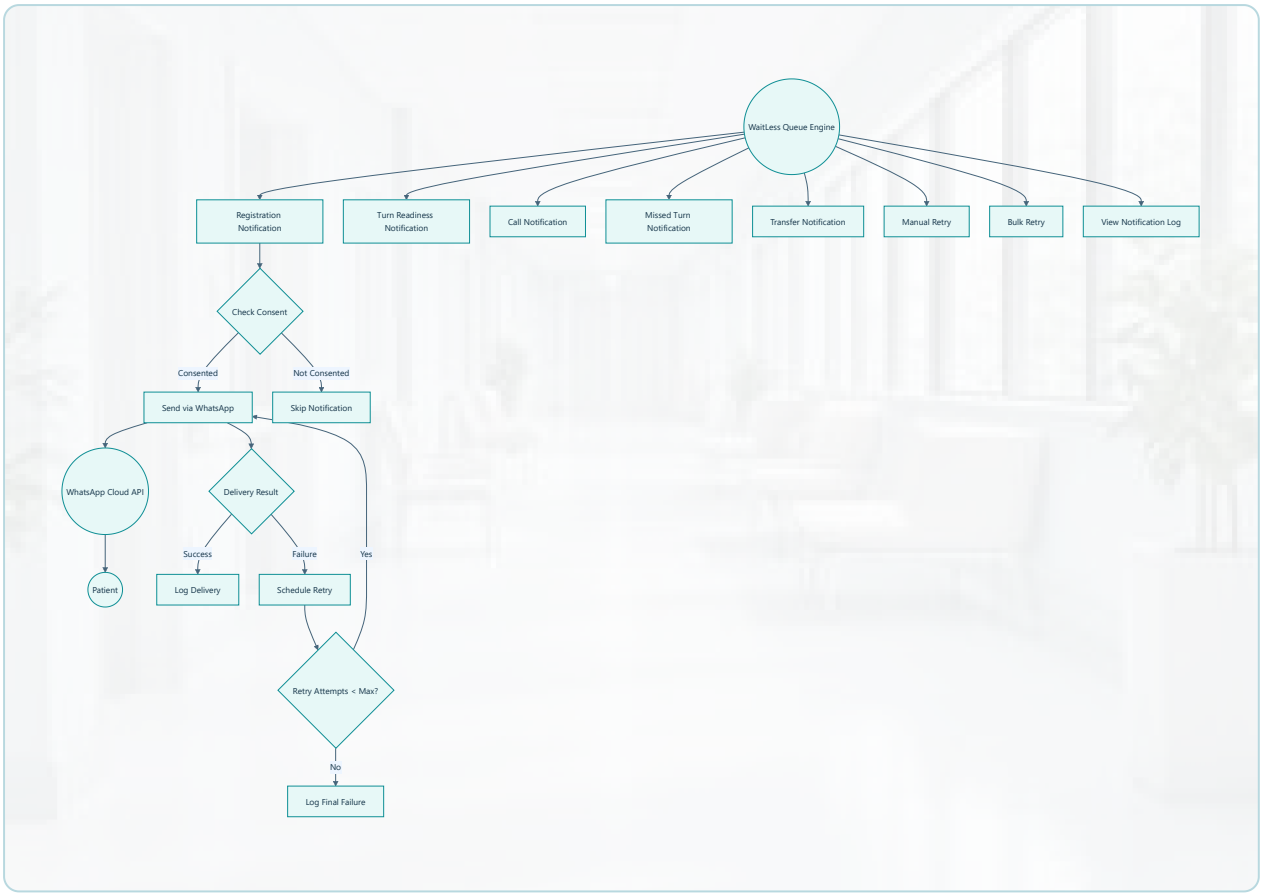
3.3.3 Triage Use Case Diagram



3.3.4 Queue Management Use Case Diagram



3.3.5 Notification Use Case Diagram



3.4 Use Case Descriptions

Use Case UC-01: Register New Patient

Field	Description
Use Case ID	UC-01
Use Case Name	Register New Patient
Actor(s)	Reception Staff
Description	A reception staff member registers a new patient entering the hospital, capturing demographics, next of kin, chief complaint, and department selection. The system generates a unique queue token and prints a ticket.
Preconditions	Staff member is authenticated with reception role. Department queue is operational.
Postconditions	Patient is registered in the system. A queue ticket is created with a unique token. Patient appears in the department waiting queue.

Field	Description
Main Flow	1. Staff selects "Register Patient" from the dashboard. 2. Staff enters patient demographics (name, national ID, DOB, gender, phone, address). 3. Staff selects patient category (walk-in, referred, emergency, etc.). 4. Staff enters next of kin details. 5. Staff enters chief complaint. 6. Staff selects destination department. 7. Staff sets notification consent (WhatsApp opt-in). 8. Staff submits the form. 9. System validates inputs. 10. System creates or links a patient profile. 11. System generates a department-specific queue token (e.g., OPD-205). 12. System creates a ticket with status "waiting" and priority "green". 13. System broadcasts a queue update event via SSE. 14. System sends a registration WhatsApp notification if consented. 15. System displays the ticket with QR code for printing.
Alternate Flows	**A1: Returning patient found.** At step 10, if a matching patient profile is found by name, phone, or national ID, the system links to the existing profile instead of creating a new one. **A2: Validation error.** At step 9, if required fields are missing or invalid, the system displays validation errors and the staff corrects the input.
Exceptions	**E1: Database unavailable.** If the database is unreachable, the system falls back to file-based storage (if configured) or displays an error message.
Business Rules	Queue tokens are immutable once generated. Token prefixes are department-specific (OPD, TRI, PHA, LAB, RAD, OIC). Sequence numbers are persistent and monotonic.
Frequency	High — performed many times daily.

Use Case UC-02: Triage Assessment

Field	Description
Use Case ID	UC-02
Use Case Name	Triage Assessment
Actor(s)	Triage Nurse
Description	A triage nurse conducts a structured assessment of a waiting patient, recording vitals, symptoms, pain score, and severity. The system auto-classifies priority based on emergency vital thresholds, with manual override capability.
Preconditions	Patient exists in the queue with status "waiting". Triage nurse is authenticated with triage role.
Postconditions	Patient's priority is updated. Triage assessment is recorded with assessor identity and timestamp. If Red priority, emergency fast-tracking is triggered. Queue order is updated.

Field	Description
Main Flow	1. Nurse selects a waiting patient from the triage queue. 2. Nurse records chief complaint (if not already captured). 3. Nurse records vitals: oxygen saturation, heart rate, blood pressure (systolic/diastolic), temperature, respiratory rate. 4. Nurse records pain score (0–10). 5. Nurse records symptoms and severity notes. 6. System evaluates vitals against emergency thresholds. 7. If any vital exceeds emergency thresholds, system auto-assigns Red priority. 8. If no emergency thresholds are exceeded, nurse manually selects priority (Red/Yellow/Green/Black). 9. System saves the triage assessment with assessor ID and timestamp. 10. System updates the patient's priority in the queue. 11. If Red priority, system triggers emergency fast-tracking (moves patient to front of queue). 12. System broadcasts a queue update event via SSE. 13. System records an audit event with before/after priority.
Alternate Flows	**A1: Manual override.** At step 8, the nurse may override an auto-Red classification if clinical judgement differs. The override is recorded with the original and new priority. **A2: Patient already triaged.** If the patient has a prior triage assessment, the nurse can update it, and both the original and updated values are retained.
Exceptions	**E1: Patient not found.** If the selected patient no longer exists in the queue, the system displays an error and returns to the triage list.
Business Rules	Emergency vital thresholds: SpO2 < 90%, HR outside 40–130 bpm, systolic BP outside 80–180 mmHg, temperature >= 39.5°C, respiratory rate outside 8–30/min, pain score >= 9. Priority order: Red (0) > Yellow (1) > Green (2) > Black (3).
Frequency	High — performed for every Casualty/Triage patient.

Use Case UC-03: Call Next Patient

Field	Description
Use Case ID	UC-03
Use Case Name	Call Next Patient
Actor(s)	Clinician
Description	A clinician calls the next patient in their department queue. The system selects the highest-priority, longest-waiting patient and updates their status to "called".
Preconditions	Clinician is authenticated. At least one patient is waiting in the department queue.
Postconditions	Selected patient's status is "called". Patient is removed from the waiting list. A call notification is sent if consented. Queue display boards update in real-time.

Field	Description
Main Flow	1. Clinician clicks "Call Next" on the dashboard. 2. System retrieves all waiting tickets for the clinician's department. 3. System sorts by priority rank (Red first), then by registration time (earliest first). 4. System selects the top ticket. 5. System updates the ticket status to "called" and records the called_at timestamp. 6. System broadcasts a "ticket.called" event via SSE. 7. System sends a WhatsApp call notification if the patient consented. 8. System dispatches turn-readiness notifications for remaining waiting patients. 9. System displays the called patient's details to the clinician.
Alternate Flows	**A1: No waiting patients.** If no patients are waiting in the department, the system displays "No patients waiting" and no action is taken.
Exceptions	**E1: Concurrent call.** If two clinicians call next simultaneously, the system processes requests sequentially; the second clinician receives the next available patient.
Business Rules	Priority sorting: Red > Yellow > Green > Black. Within the same priority, earliest registration time is called first. Called patients have a configurable window before being marked missed.
Frequency	High — performed continuously during clinic hours.

Use Case UC-04: Missed Turn and Recall

Field	Description
Use Case ID	UC-04
Use Case Name	Mark Missed Turn and Recall
Actor(s)	Clinician
Description	A clinician marks a called patient as missed when they do not present for service. The patient is moved to a recall lane. The clinician can later recall the patient, reinserting them into the queue.
Preconditions	Patient has status "called".
Postconditions	Patient status is "missed". Missed notification is sent. Patient appears in the recall lane. On recall, patient is reinserted into the waiting queue.

Field	Description
Main Flow	1. Clinician selects a called patient and clicks "Mark Missed". 2. System updates the ticket status to "missed" and records the missed_at timestamp. 3. System broadcasts a "ticket.missed" event via SSE. 4. System sends a missed-turn WhatsApp notification if consented. 5. Patient appears in the missed/recall lane on the dashboard and display board. 6. When the patient returns, clinician clicks "Recall". 7. System updates the ticket status to "waiting" and records the recalled_at timestamp. 8. System increments the recall count. 9. System reinserts the patient into the waiting queue. 10. System broadcasts a "ticket.recalled" event via SSE.
Alternate Flows	**A1: Configurable reinsertion.** The reinsertion position can be configured (e.g., after 3 patients) to balance fairness with flow.
Business Rules	Recall count is tracked per ticket. Multiple recalls are allowed. The registration time may be reset on recall depending on configuration.
Frequency	Medium — occurs when patients step away during their turn.

Use Case UC-05: Queue Transfer

Field	Description
Use Case ID	UC-05
Use Case Name	Transfer Patient Between Departments
Actor(s)	Clinician, Reception Staff
Description	A staff member transfers a patient from one department queue to another, recording the previous department and notifying the patient.
Preconditions	Patient exists in the queue with a non-completed status. Target department is valid.
Postconditions	Patient's department is updated. Previous department is recorded. Transfer notification is sent. Patient appears in the target department's waiting queue.
Main Flow	1. Staff selects a patient and clicks "Transfer". 2. Staff selects the target department from the dropdown. 3. System validates the target department exists. 4. System records the previous department. 5. System updates the ticket's department and sets transferred_at timestamp. 6. System broadcasts a "ticket.transferred" event via SSE. 7. System sends a transfer WhatsApp notification with the new department and directions. 8. System dispatches turn-readiness notifications for the updated queue.
Alternate Flows	None.

Field	Description
Exceptions	**E1: Invalid department.** If the target department is the same as the current department or does not exist, the system displays an error.
Business Rules	Only non-completed tickets can be transferred. The previous department is retained for audit and tracking purposes.
Frequency	Medium — occurs when patients need services in multiple departments.

Use Case UC-06: Patient Self-Tracking

Field	Description
Use Case ID	UC-06
Use Case Name	Track Queue Status
Actor(s)	Patient
Description	A patient enters their queue token on the public tracking page to view their current queue position, estimated wait time, patients ahead, and notification history.
Preconditions	Patient has a valid queue token.
Postconditions	Patient views their current queue status. No state changes occur.
Main Flow	1. Patient navigates to the tracking page (/track). 2. Patient enters their queue token (e.g., OPD-205). 3. System looks up the ticket by normalised token code. 4. System retrieves the ticket's current status, department, priority, and position. 5. System calculates the estimated wait time based on historical service time and queue position. 6. System retrieves the patient's notification history. 7. System displays: token, department, current status, position in queue, patients ahead, estimated wait time, progress indicator, and department directions. 8. Page updates in real-time via SSE when queue state changes.
Alternate Flows	**A1: Token not found.** If the token does not match any ticket, the system displays "Ticket not found" and prompts re-entry.
Exceptions	None.
Business Rules	Tracking is public and does not require authentication. Only the token code is needed. Patient name is not displayed on the tracking page for privacy.
Frequency	High — patients check frequently during their wait.

Use Case UC-07: Kiosk Self-Check-in

Field	Description
Use Case ID	UC-07
Use Case Name	Kiosk Self-Check-in
Actor(s)	Patient
Description	A patient uses a self-service kiosk to check in by scanning a QR card or entering a phone number, selecting a department and visit reason, and receiving a queue token.
Preconditions	Kiosk device is operational and connected to the network.
Postconditions	Patient is checked in. A queue ticket is created. Patient receives a token and optional WhatsApp notifications.
Main Flow	1. Patient approaches the kiosk and taps "Check In". 2. Patient identifies themselves by scanning a QR card (camera-based) or entering a phone number. 3. System searches for an existing patient profile by QR payload or phone. 4. If found, system displays the patient's name for confirmation. 5. If not found, patient enters basic demographics. 6. Patient selects the destination department. 7. Patient enters a visit reason / chief complaint. 8. Patient sets notification consent. 9. System creates a queue ticket with the next sequence number. 10. System displays the queue token and estimated wait time. 11. System broadcasts a queue update event via SSE. 12. System sends a registration notification if consented.
Alternate Flows	**A1: QR scan failure.** If the camera cannot read the QR code, the patient can manually enter their phone number or patient number.
Exceptions	**E1: Network error.** If the kiosk cannot reach the server, an error message is displayed and the patient is directed to reception.
Business Rules	Kiosk check-in creates a "waiting" ticket with "green" priority by default. Triage assessment can upgrade the priority later.
Frequency	Medium — used by walk-in patients at the hospital entrance.

Use Case UC-08: Send WhatsApp Notification

Field	Description
Use Case ID	UC-08
Use Case Name	Send WhatsApp Notification
Actor(s)	System (automated)

Field	Description
Description	The system sends a WhatsApp message to a patient for registration, turn readiness, call, missed turn, or transfer events, with automatic retry on failure.
Preconditions	Patient has notification consent enabled. Patient has a valid phone number. WhatsApp provider is configured (mock or Meta Cloud API).
Postconditions	Notification record is created with delivery status. If successful, message is delivered. If failed, retry is scheduled.
Main Flow	1. A queue event triggers notification dispatch (registration, call, missed, transfer, turn readiness). 2. System checks the patient's notification consent. 3. System creates a notification record with type, channel, recipient, and message content. 4. System resolves the WhatsApp template for the notification type. 5. System sends the message via the configured provider (mock or Meta Cloud API). 6. If delivery succeeds, system records the provider message ID and sets status to "sent"/"delivered". 7. If delivery fails, system records the error code and message, and schedules a retry based on configured retry delays (15s, 60s, 300s). 8. System creates a notification attempt record for each attempt. 9. Retry continues until max attempts is reached or delivery succeeds.
Alternate Flows	**A1: Manual retry.** Staff can manually retry a failed notification from the dashboard. **A2: Bulk retry.** Staff can retry multiple failed notifications simultaneously.
Exceptions	**E1: Provider unavailable.** If the WhatsApp API is unreachable, the notification is queued for retry. **E2: Invalid phone number.** If the phone number is invalid, the notification is marked as failed with an error code.
Business Rules	Retry delays: 15 seconds, 60 seconds, 300 seconds (configurable). Max attempts: configurable per notification. Mock provider simulates delivery with configurable delay and failure rate for development.
Frequency	High — triggered by every queue event for consented patients.

Use Case UC-09: View Reports

Field	Description
Use Case ID	UC-09
Use Case Name	View Operational Reports
Actor(s)	Administrator, Clinician
Description	A staff member views operational reports including average waiting time, department performance, no-show analysis, triage outcomes, and WhatsApp status, with date range filtering.

Field	Description
Preconditions	Staff member is authenticated.
Postconditions	Report data is displayed. No state changes occur.
Main Flow	1. Staff navigates to the Reports page. 2. Staff selects a report tab (Overview, Average Wait Time, Department Performance, No-Show, Triage, WhatsApp Status). 3. Staff selects a date range (from/to). 4. System fetches report data from the API with date filters. 5. System displays the report with summary metrics, department breakdowns, and detailed tables.
Alternate Flows	None.
Exceptions	**E1: No data.** If no tickets exist in the selected date range, the system displays an empty state message.
Business Rules	Reports are read-only. Date filtering applies to ticket registration date. Department scoping applies to non-admin staff.
Frequency	Medium — used for daily/weekly operational review.

Use Case UC-10: View Audit Trail

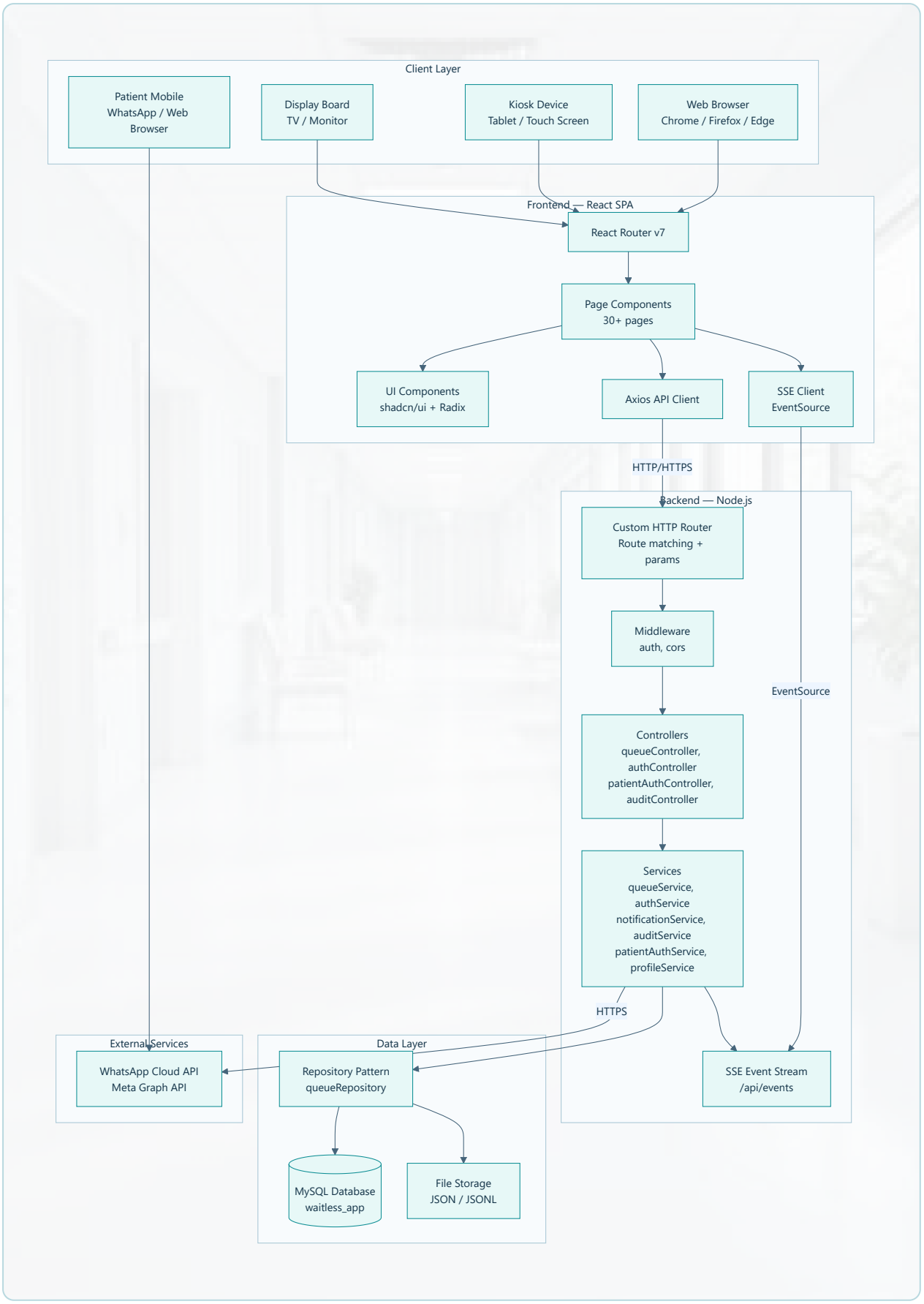
Field	Description
Use Case ID	UC-10
Use Case Name	View Audit Trail
Actor(s)	Administrator
Description	An administrator views the immutable audit trail of all system actions, including actor, timestamp, action type, entity, before/after state, and hash chain verification.
Preconditions	Administrator is authenticated with admin role.
Postconditions	Audit events are displayed. No state changes occur (audit trail is read-only).
Main Flow	1. Administrator navigates to the Audit Trail page. 2. System retrieves audit events from the database, ordered by occurrence time (most recent first). 3. System displays each event with: timestamp, actor name/role/department, action, entity type/ID, outcome, and before/after state. 4. Administrator can filter by action type, actor, or date range. 5. System displays the hash chain verification status.
Alternate Flows	None.

Field	Description
Exceptions	**E1: Hash chain broken.** If a tamper event is detected, the system flags the compromised event(s) in the audit display.
Business Rules	Audit events are append-only and cannot be modified or deleted. Each event's hash incorporates the previous event's hash, creating a verifiable chain. Sensitive data (passwords, tokens) is redacted in audit records. Only administrators can view the audit trail.
Frequency	Low — used for security review and compliance.

3.5 System Architecture

3.5.1 High-Level Architecture

The WaitLess system follows a client-server architecture with a React single-page application frontend, a Node.js backend with a custom HTTP router, a dual-mode data layer (MySQL or file-based JSON), and integration with the WhatsApp Cloud API for external notifications.


Client Layer
Patient Mobile
WhatsApp / Web
Browser
Display Board
TV / Monitor
Kiosk Device
Tablet / Touch Screen
Web Browser
Chrome / Firefox / Edge
Frontend — React SPA
React Router v7
Page Components
30+ pages
UI Components
shadcn/ui + Radix
Axios API Client
SSE Client
EventSource
HTTP/HTTPS
Backend — Node.js
Custom HTTP Router
Route matching +
params
Middleware
auth, cors
EventSource
Controllers
queueController,
authController
patientAuthController,
auditController
Services
queueService,
authService
notificationService,
auditService
patientAuthService,
profileService
HTTPS
External Services
WhatsApp Cloud API
Meta Graph API
Data Layer
Repository Pattern
queueRepository
SSE Event Stream
/api/events
MySQL Database
waitless_app
File Storage
JSON / JSONL

3.5.2 Layered Architecture Description

The system follows a strict layered architecture with clear separation of concerns:

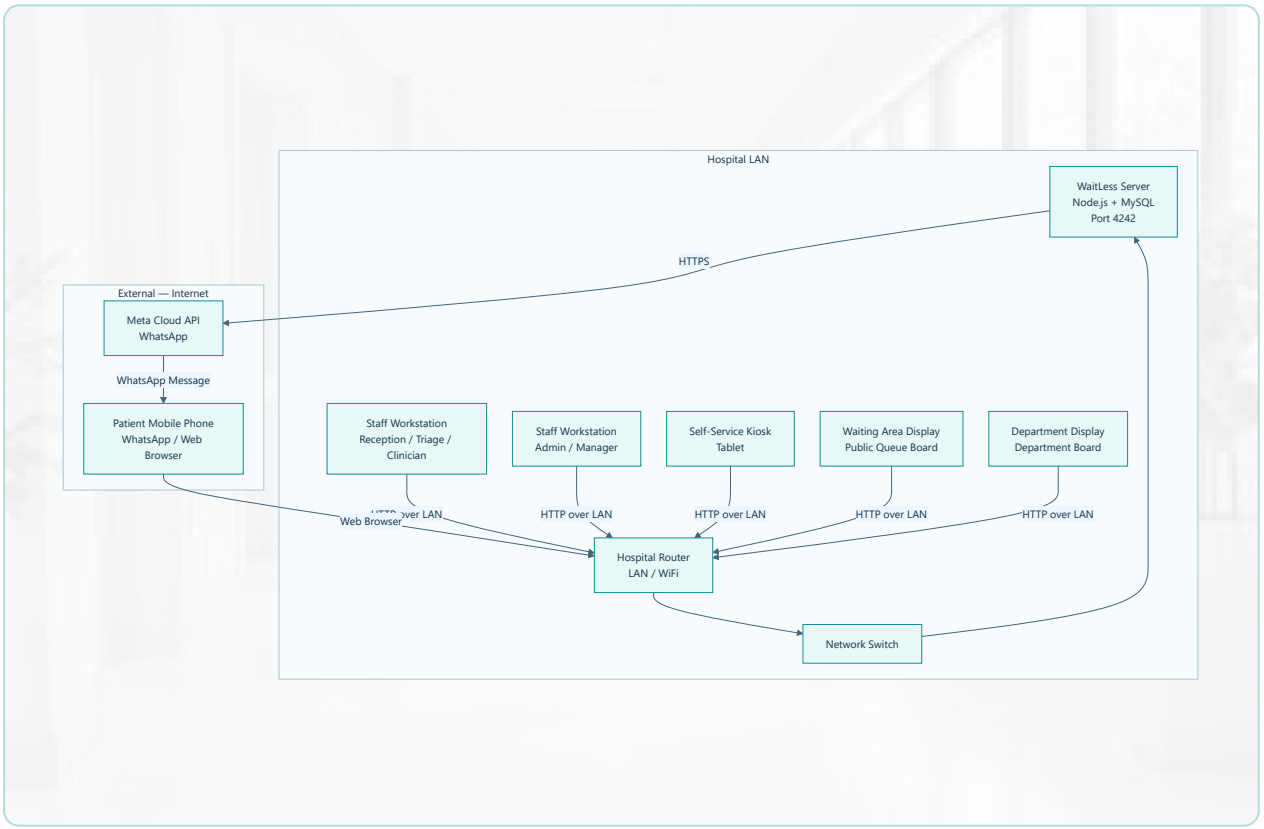
Layer	Responsibility	Key Files
Presentation Layer	Renders UI, captures user input, displays real-time updates	`frontend/src/pages/`, `frontend/src/components/`
API/Controller Layer	Receives HTTP requests, validates input, calls services, formats responses	`backend/src/controllers/`, `backend/src/index.js`
Service/Business Logic Layer	Implements domain rules, queue algorithms, notification dispatch, authentication	`backend/src/services/`
Repository/Data Access Layer	Abstracts data persistence, supports MySQL and file-based modes	`backend/src/repositories/`
External Integration Layer	Communicates with WhatsApp Cloud API	`backend/src/services/whatsAppProvider.js`

3.5.3 Technology Architecture

Component	Technology	Version
Frontend Framework	React	19.2.0
Build Tool	Vite	7.3.1
Routing	React Router DOM	7.10.1
Styling	Tailwind CSS	4.2.1
UI Components	Radix UI (shadcn/ui)	Various
Charts	Recharts	2.15.4
HTTP Client	Axios	1.7.9
Form Validation	Zod + react-hook-form	3.24.2 / 7.71.2
Icons	Lucide React	0.575.0
Toast Notifications	Sonner	2.0.7

Component	Technology	Version
QR Code	qrcode	1.5.4
QR Scanning	html5-qrcode	2.3.8
Backend Runtime	Node.js	18+ (ESM)
Database Driver	mysql2	3.6.0
Password Hashing	bcryptjs	2.4.3
Environment Config	dotenv	16.3.1
Real-time Protocol	Server-Sent Events (SSE)	Native
Notification Provider	WhatsApp Cloud API (Meta Graph)	v23.0

3.5.4 Deployment Architecture

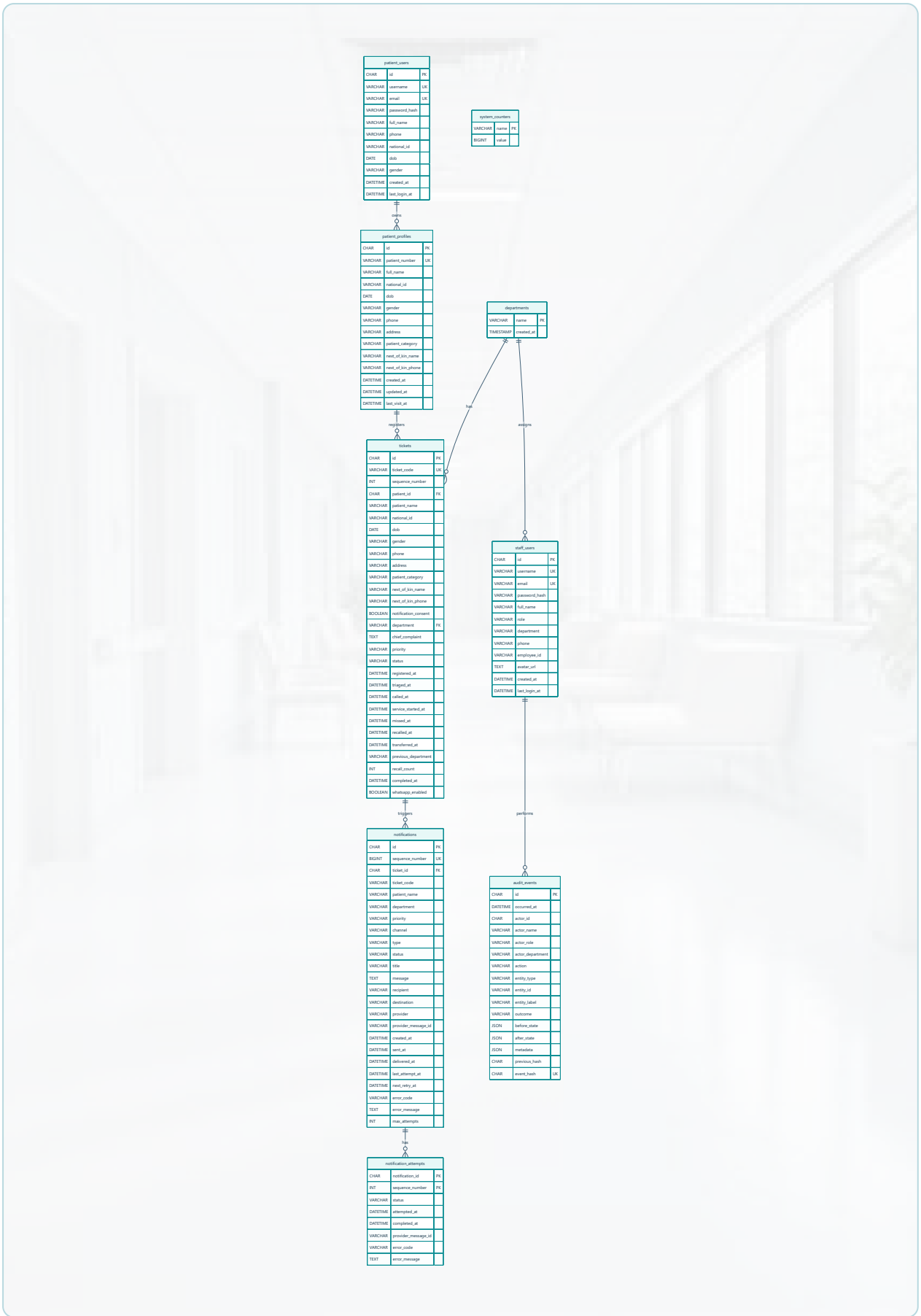


The system is designed for primary deployment on a hospital local area network (LAN). The Node.js server and MySQL database run on a single machine or a small server within the hospital network. Staff workstations, kiosks, and display boards connect to the server over the LAN via standard HTTP. External WhatsApp notifications are sent via HTTPS to the Meta Cloud API, which

requires internet connectivity. The system can operate in a reduced capacity (core queue management without notifications) when internet is unavailable.

3.6 Data Design

3.6.1 Entity-Relationship Diagram


patient_users
CHAR id PK
VARCHAR username UK
VARCHAR email UK
VARCHAR password_hash
VARCHAR full_name
VARCHAR phone
VARCHAR national_id
DATE dob
VARCHAR gender
DATETIME created_at
DATETIME last_login_at
system_counters
VARCHAR name PK
BIGINT value
owns
patient_profiles
CHAR id PK
VARCHAR patient_number UK
VARCHAR full_name
VARCHAR national_id
DATE dob
VARCHAR gender
VARCHAR phone
VARCHAR address
VARCHAR patient_category
VARCHAR next_of_kin_name
VARCHAR next_of_kin_phone
DATETIME created_at
DATETIME updated_at
DATETIME last_visit_at
departments
VARCHAR name PK
TIMESTAMP created_at
has
assigns
registers
tickets
CHAR id PK
VARCHAR ticket_code UK
INT sequence_number
CHAR patient_id FK
VARCHAR patient_name
VARCHAR national_id
DATE dob
VARCHAR gender
VARCHAR phone
VARCHAR address
VARCHAR patient_category
VARCHAR next_of_kin_name
VARCHAR next_of_kin_phone
BOOLEAN notification_consent
VARCHAR department FK
TEXT chief_complaint
VARCHAR priority
VARCHAR status
DATETIME registered_at
DATETIME triaged_at
DATETIME called_at
DATETIME service_started_at
DATETIME missed_at
DATETIME recalled_at
DATETIME transferred_at
VARCHAR previous_department
INT recall_count
DATETIME completed_at
BOOLEAN whatsapp_enabled
staff_users
CHAR id PK
VARCHAR username UK
VARCHAR email UK
VARCHAR password_hash
VARCHAR full_name
VARCHAR role
VARCHAR department
VARCHAR phone
VARCHAR employee_id
TEXT avatar_url
DATETIME created_at
DATETIME last_login_at
triggers
performs
notifications
CHAR id PK
BIGINT sequence_number UK
CHAR ticket_id FK
VARCHAR ticket_code
VARCHAR patient_name
VARCHAR department
VARCHAR priority
VARCHAR channel
VARCHAR type
VARCHAR status
VARCHAR title
TEXT message
VARCHAR recipient
VARCHAR destination
VARCHAR provider
VARCHAR provider_message_id
DATETIME created_at
DATETIME sent_at
DATETIME delivered_at
DATETIME last_attempt_at
DATETIME next_retry_at
VARCHAR error_code
TEXT error_message
INT max_attempts
audit_events
CHAR id PK
DATETIME occurred_at
CHAR actor_id
VARCHAR actor_name
VARCHAR actor_role
VARCHAR actor_department
VARCHAR action
VARCHAR entity_type
VARCHAR entity_id
VARCHAR entity_label
VARCHAR outcome
JSON before_state
JSON after_state
JSON metadata
CHAR previous_hash
CHAR event_hash UK
has
notification_attempts
CHAR notification_id PK
INT sequence_number PK
VARCHAR status
DATETIME attempted_at
DATETIME completed_at
VARCHAR provider_message_id
VARCHAR error_code
TEXT error_message

3.6.2 Data Dictionary

Table: departments

Column	Type	Constraints	Description
name	VARCHAR(80)	PRIMARY KEY	Department name (e.g., "OPD", "Casualty / Triage")
created_at	TIMESTAMP(3)	NOT NULL, DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP	Record creation timestamp

Table: patient_profiles

Column	Type	Constraints	Description
id	CHAR(36)	PRIMARY KEY	UUID identifier
patient_number	VARCHAR(24)	NOT NULL, UNIQUE	Permanent patient number (e.g., "PT-0001")
full_name	VARCHAR(160)	NOT NULL	Patient's full name
national_id	VARCHAR(80)	NULL	National ID number
dob	DATE	NULL	Date of birth
gender	VARCHAR(40)	NOT NULL, DEFAULT 'unknown'	Gender (male/female/unknown)
phone	VARCHAR(80)	NULL	Phone number for notifications
address	VARCHAR(255)	NOT NULL, DEFAULT ''	Residential address
patient_category	VARCHAR(80)	NOT NULL, DEFAULT 'walk-in'	Category (walk-in, referred, emergency, etc.)
next_of_kin_name	VARCHAR(160)	NOT NULL, DEFAULT ''	Next of kin full name
next_of_kin_phone	VARCHAR(80)	NOT NULL, DEFAULT ''	Next of kin phone number
created_at	DATETIME(3)	NOT NULL	Profile creation timestamp
updated_at	DATETIME(3)	NOT NULL	Last update timestamp
last_visit_at	DATETIME(3)	NULL	Last visit timestamp

Indexes: idx_patient_profiles_name (full_name), idx_patient_profiles_national_id (national_id), idx_patient_profiles_phone (phone)

Table: tickets

Column	Type	Constraints	Description
id	CHAR(36)	PRIMARY KEY	UUID identifier
ticket_code	VARCHAR(20)	NOT NULL, UNIQUE	Queue token (e.g., "OPD-205")
sequence_number	INT	NOT NULL	Department-specific sequence
patient_id	CHAR(36)	NULL, FK → patient_profiles(id)	Linked patient profile
patient_name	VARCHAR(160)	NOT NULL	Patient name (denormalised)
national_id	VARCHAR(80)	NOT NULL, DEFAULT ''	National ID (denormalised)
dob	DATE	NULL	Date of birth (denormalised)
gender	VARCHAR(40)	NOT NULL, DEFAULT 'unknown'	Gender (denormalised)
phone	VARCHAR(80)	NOT NULL, DEFAULT ''	Phone (denormalised)
address	VARCHAR(255)	NOT NULL, DEFAULT ''	Address (denormalised)
patient_category	VARCHAR(80)	NOT NULL, DEFAULT 'walk-in'	Category (denormalised)
next_of_kin_name	VARCHAR(160)	NOT NULL, DEFAULT ''	Next of kin name (denormalised)
next_of_kin_phone	VARCHAR(80)	NOT NULL, DEFAULT ''	Next of kin phone (denormalised)
notification_consent	BOOLEAN	NOT NULL, DEFAULT FALSE	WhatsApp notification opt-in
department	VARCHAR(80)	NOT NULL, FK → departments(name)	Current department
chief_complaint	TEXT	NULL	Patient's chief complaint
priority	VARCHAR(20)	NOT NULL	Priority level (red/yellow/green/black)
status	VARCHAR(30)	NOT NULL	Ticket status (waiting/called/in-service/missed/completed)
registered_at	DATETIME(3)	NOT NULL	Registration timestamp
triaged_at	DATETIME(3)	NULL	Triage assessment timestamp
called_at	DATETIME(3)	NULL	When patient was called

Column	Type	Constraints	Description
service_started_at	DATETIME(3)	NULL	When service began
missed_at	DATETIME(3)	NULL	When marked missed
recalled_at	DATETIME(3)	NULL	When recalled
transferred_at	DATETIME(3)	NULL	When transferred
previous_department	VARCHAR(80)	NOT NULL, DEFAULT ''	Previous department (for transfers)
recall_count	INT	NOT NULL, DEFAULT 0	Number of recalls
completed_at	DATETIME(3)	NULL	Service completion timestamp
whatsapp_enabled	BOOLEAN	NOT NULL, DEFAULT FALSE	WhatsApp enabled flag

Indexes: idx_tickets_department_status (department, status), idx_tickets_priority_status (priority, status), idx_tickets_registered_at (registered_at), idx_tickets_patient_id (patient_id)

Table: notifications

Column	Type	Constraints	Description
id	CHAR(36)	PRIMARY KEY	UUID identifier
sequence_number	BIGINT	NOT NULL, UNIQUE	Monotonic sequence
ticket_id	CHAR(36)	NOT NULL, FK → tickets(id)	Related ticket
ticket_code	VARCHAR(20)	NOT NULL	Ticket code (denormalised)
patient_name	VARCHAR(160)	NOT NULL	Patient name (denormalised)
department	VARCHAR(80)	NOT NULL	Department (denormalised)
priority	VARCHAR(20)	NOT NULL	Priority (denormalised)
channel	VARCHAR(40)	NOT NULL	Notification channel (whatsapp, display-board)
type	VARCHAR(80)	NOT NULL	Notification type (queue.registered, queue.called, etc.)
status	VARCHAR(40)	NOT NULL	Delivery status (pending, sent, delivered, failed)
title	VARCHAR(255)	NOT NULL	Notification title

Column	Type	Constraints	Description
message	TEXT	NOT NULL	Message body
recipient	VARCHAR(160)	NOT NULL	Recipient phone number
destination	VARCHAR(160)	NULL	Destination department
provider	VARCHAR(80)	NULL	Provider name (mock, meta-cloud)
provider_message_id	VARCHAR(160)	NULL	Provider's message ID
created_at	DATETIME(3)	NOT NULL	Creation timestamp
sent_at	DATETIME(3)	NULL	When sent to provider
delivered_at	DATETIME(3)	NULL	When delivered
last_attempt_at	DATETIME(3)	NULL	Last attempt timestamp
next_retry_at	DATETIME(3)	NULL	Next scheduled retry
error_code	VARCHAR(80)	NULL	Error code from provider
error_message	TEXT	NULL	Error message from provider
max_attempts	INT	NOT NULL, DEFAULT 1	Maximum retry attempts

Indexes: idx_notifications_ticket_id, idx_notifications_status, idx_notifications_channel, idx_notifications_provider_message_id, idx_notifications_created_at

Table: notification_attempts

Column	Type	Constraints	Description
notification_id	CHAR(36)	PK, FK → notifications(id)	Related notification
sequence_number	INT	PK	Attempt sequence
status	VARCHAR(40)	NOT NULL	Attempt status
attempted_at	DATETIME(3)	NOT NULL	Attempt timestamp
completed_at	DATETIME(3)	NULL	Completion timestamp
provider_message_id	VARCHAR(160)	NULL	Provider message ID
error_code	VARCHAR(80)	NULL	Error code
error_message	TEXT	NULL	Error message

Table: staff_users

Column	Type	Constraints	Description
id	CHAR(36)	PRIMARY KEY	UUID identifier
username	VARCHAR(32)	NOT NULL, UNIQUE	Login username
email	VARCHAR(120)	NOT NULL, UNIQUE	Email address
password_hash	VARCHAR(255)	NOT NULL	bcrypt password hash
full_name	VARCHAR(160)	NOT NULL	Staff member's full name
role	VARCHAR(40)	NOT NULL, DEFAULT 'reception'	Role (admin, reception, triage, clinician)
department	VARCHAR(80)	NOT NULL, DEFAULT ''	Assigned department
phone	VARCHAR(80)	NULL	Phone number
employee_id	VARCHAR(80)	NULL	Employee ID
avatar_url	TEXT	NULL	Avatar image URL
created_at	DATETIME(3)	NOT NULL, DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP	Creation timestamp
last_login_at	DATETIME(3)	NULL	Last login timestamp

Table: patient_users

Column	Type	Constraints	Description
id	CHAR(36)	PRIMARY KEY	UUID identifier
username	VARCHAR(32)	NOT NULL, UNIQUE	Login username
email	VARCHAR(120)	NOT NULL, UNIQUE	Email address
password_hash	VARCHAR(255)	NOT NULL	bcrypt password hash
full_name	VARCHAR(160)	NOT NULL	Patient's full name
phone	VARCHAR(80)	NOT NULL	Phone number
national_id	VARCHAR(80)	NULL	National ID
dob	DATE	NULL	Date of birth
gender	VARCHAR(40)	NOT NULL, DEFAULT 'unknown'	Gender

Column	Type	Constraints	Description
created_at	DATETIME(3)	NOT NULL, DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP	Creation timestamp
last_login_at	DATETIME(3)	NULL	Last login timestamp

Table: audit_events

Column	Type	Constraints	Description
id	CHAR(36)	PRIMARY KEY	UUID identifier
occurred_at	DATETIME(3)	NOT NULL	When the event occurred
actor_id	CHAR(36)	NULL	Staff user ID who performed the action
actor_name	VARCHAR(160)	NULL	Staff name (denormalised)
actor_role	VARCHAR(40)	NULL	Staff role (denormalised)
actor_department	VARCHAR(80)	NULL	Staff department (denormalised)
action	VARCHAR(100)	NOT NULL	Action type (e.g., "ticket.create", "auth.login")
entity_type	VARCHAR(80)	NOT NULL	Entity type (ticket, staff, notification)
entity_id	VARCHAR(80)	NULL	Entity ID
entity_label	VARCHAR(160)	NULL	Entity label (e.g., ticket code)
outcome	VARCHAR(40)	NOT NULL, DEFAULT 'success'	Outcome (success, failure)
before_state	JSON	NULL	State before the action
after_state	JSON	NULL	State after the action
metadata	JSON	NULL	Additional metadata
previous_hash	CHAR(64)	NULL	Hash of the previous audit event
event_hash	CHAR(64)	NOT NULL, UNIQUE	SHA-256 hash of this event

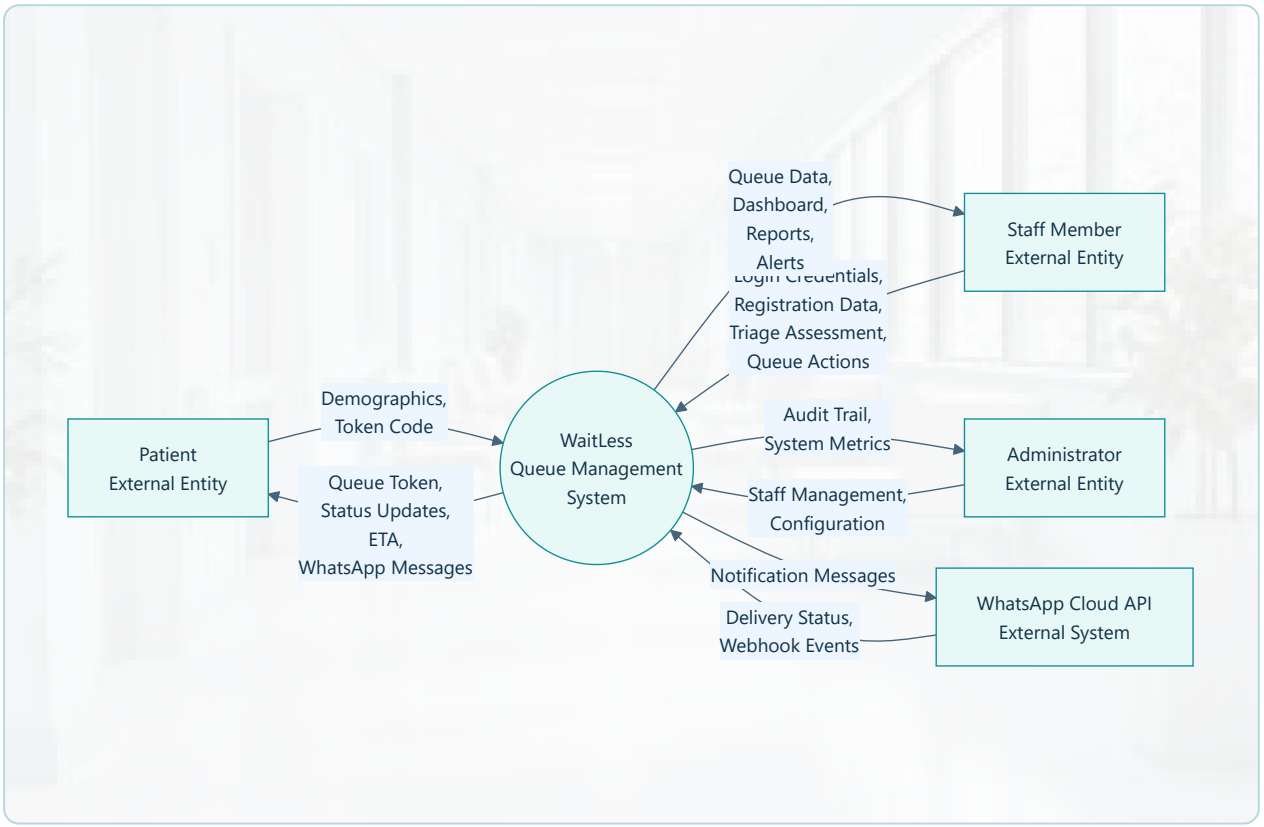
Indexes: idx_audit_events_occurred_at, idx_audit_events_actor_id, idx_audit_events_action, idx_audit_events_entity

Table: system_counters

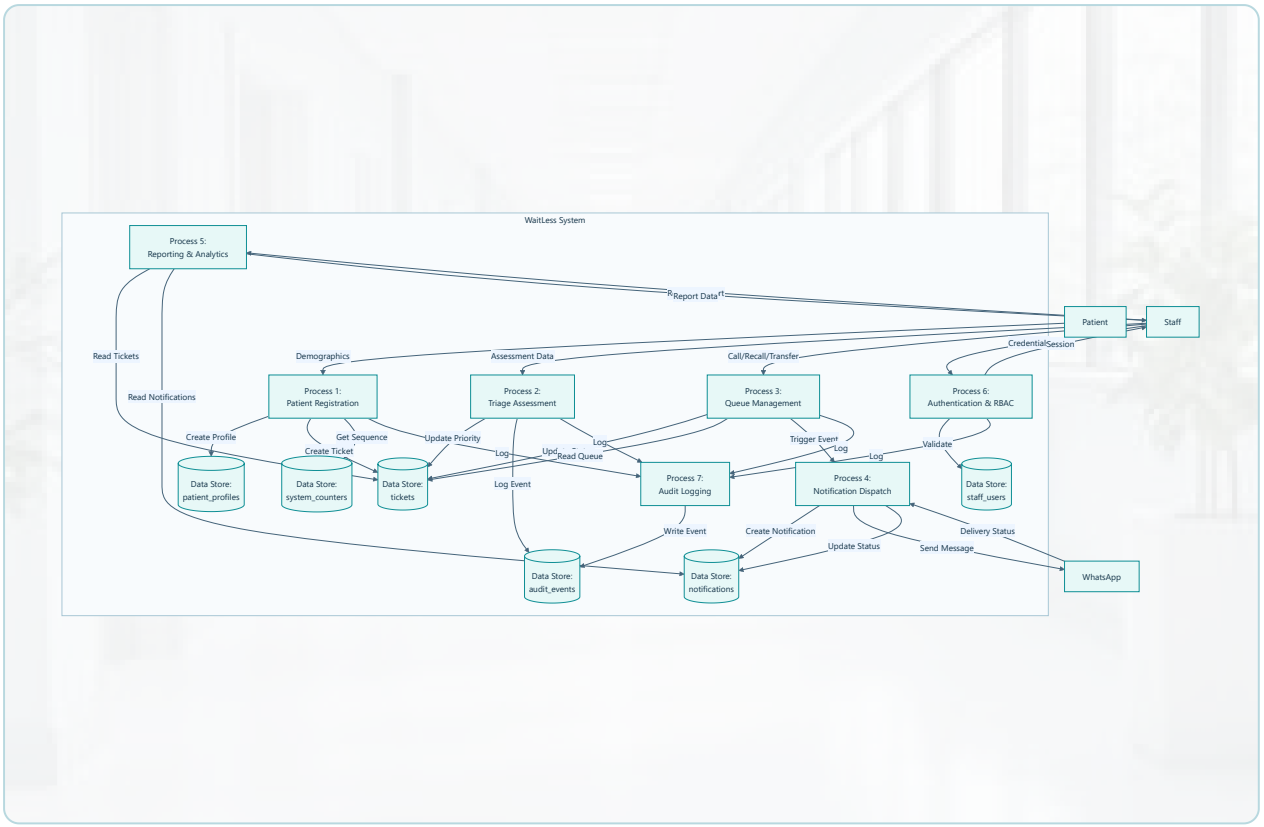
Column	Type	Constraints	Description
name	VARCHAR(80)	PRIMARY KEY	Counter name (e.g., "OPD", "TRI", "PHA")
value	BIGINT	NOT NULL	Current counter value

3.6.3 Data Flow Diagrams

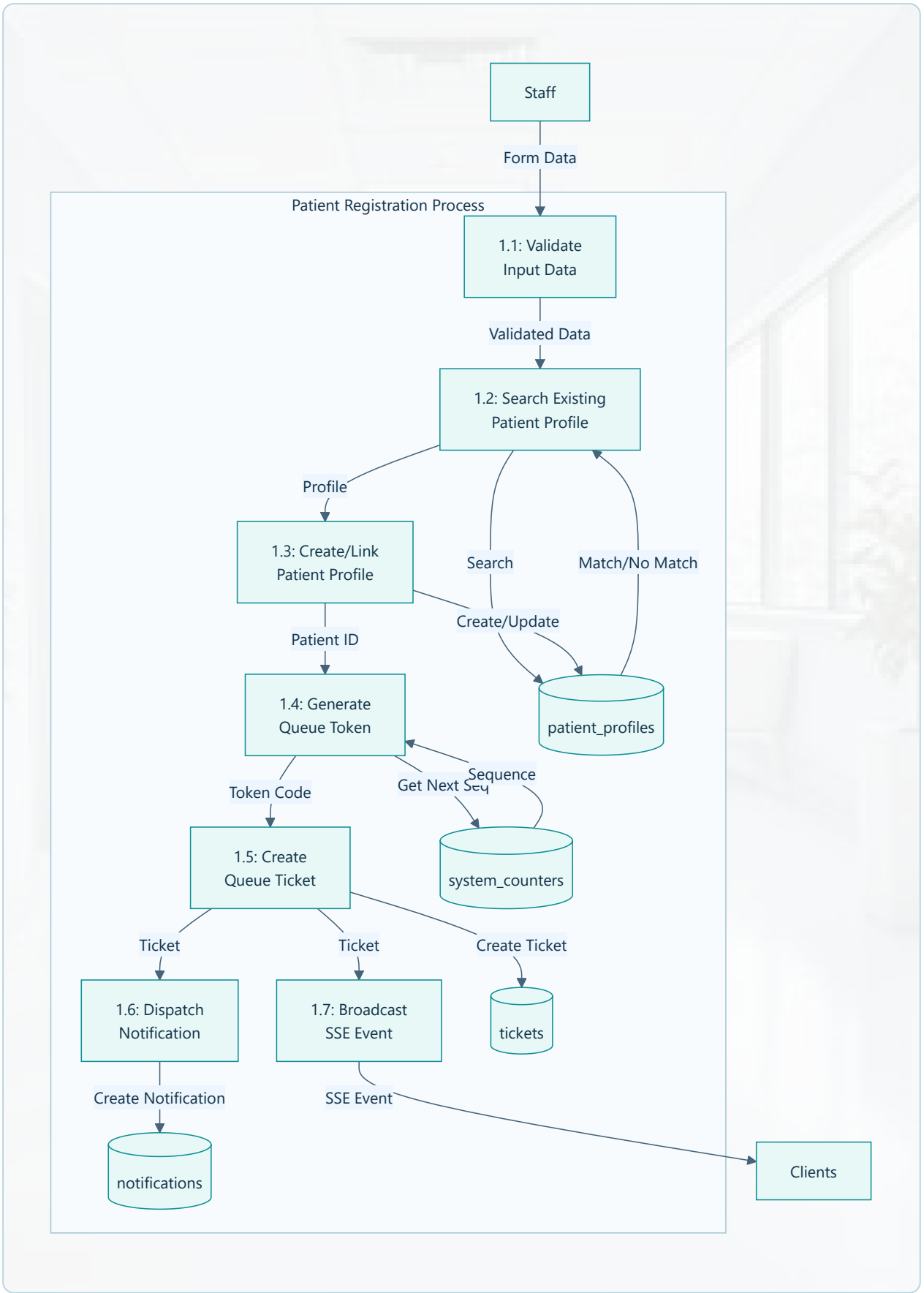
DFD Level 0 — Context Diagram



DFD Level 1 — Major Processes

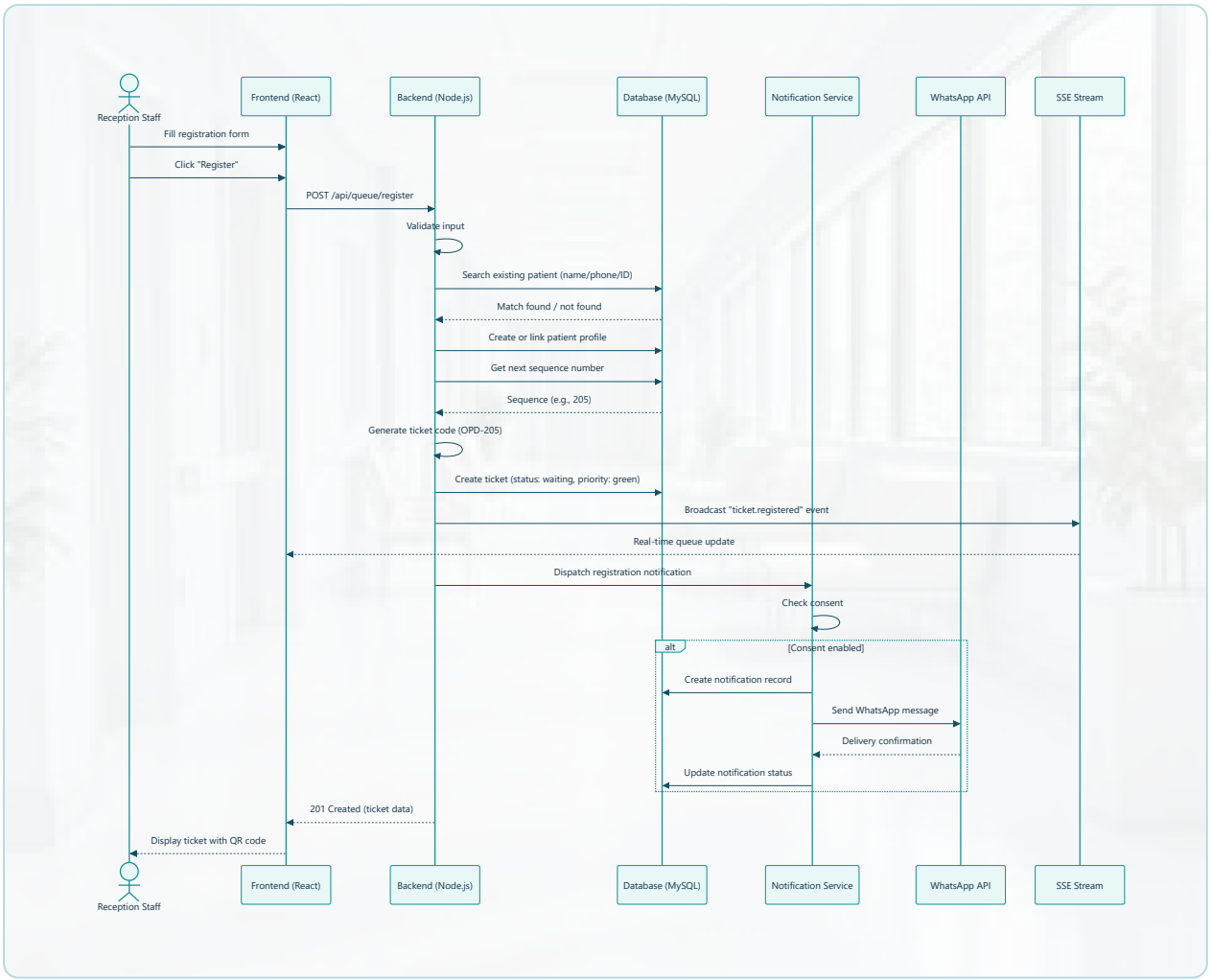


DFD Level 2 — Patient Registration Detail

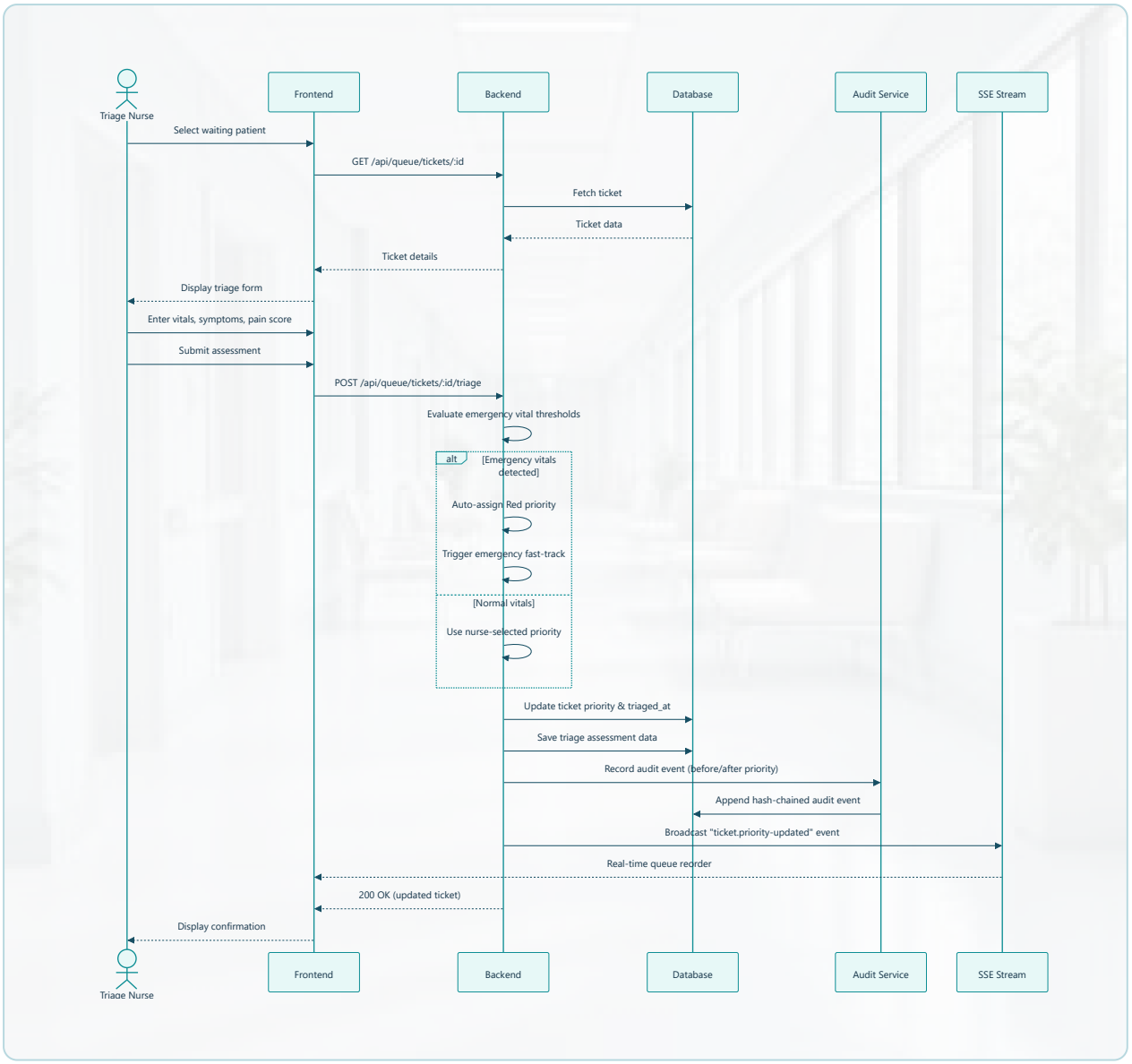

Staff
Form Data
Patient Registration Process
1.1: Validate Input Data
Validated Data
1.2: Search Existing Patient Profile
Profile
Search
Match/No Match
1.3: Create/Link Patient Profile
Create/Update
Patient ID
1.4: Generate Queue Token
patient_profiles
Sequence
Token Code
Get Next Seq
1.5: Create Queue Ticket
system_counters
Ticket
Ticket
Create Ticket
1.6: Dispatch Notification
1.7: Broadcast SSE Event
tickets
Create Notification
SSE Event
notifications
Clients

3.7 Process Design

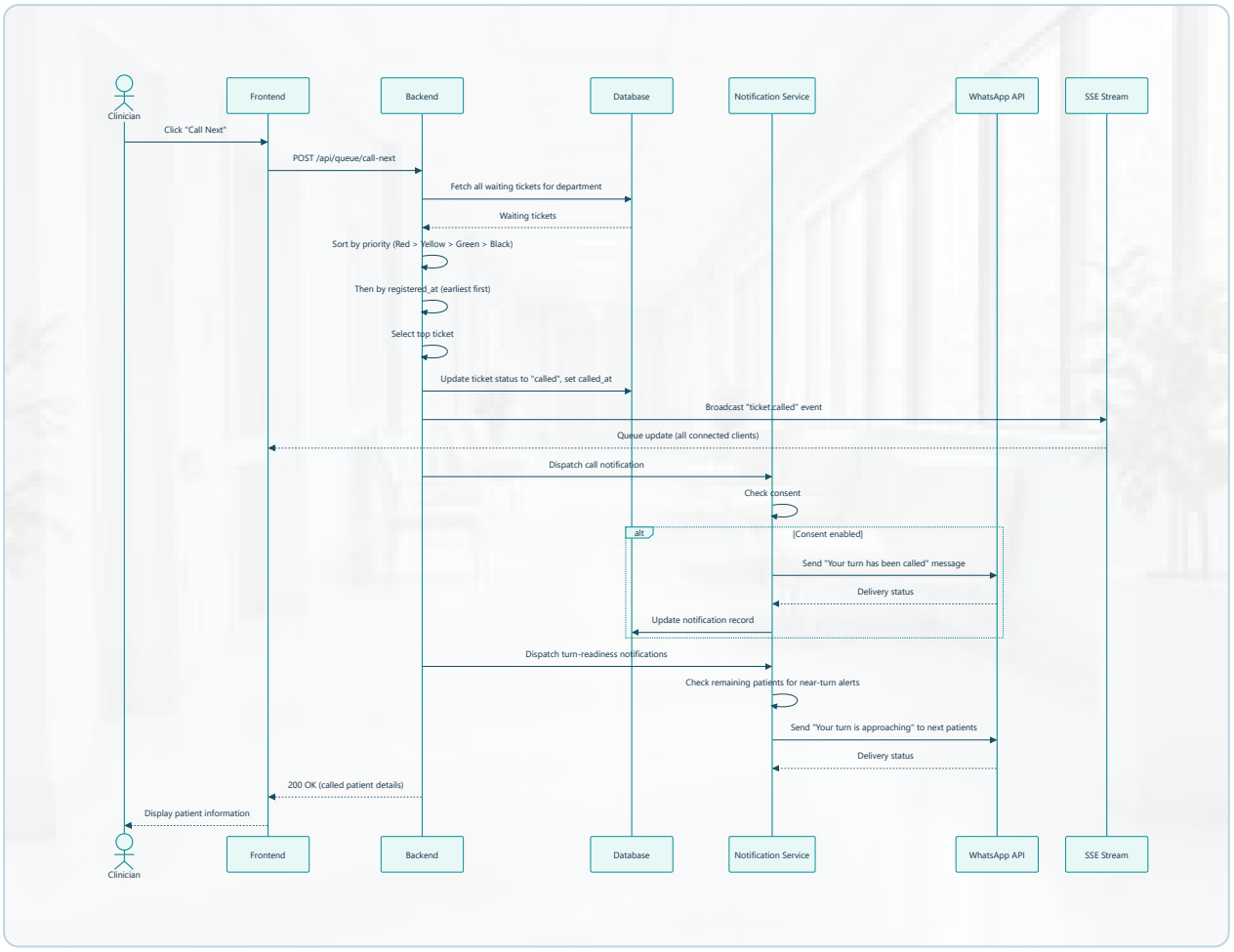
3.7.1 Sequence Diagram: Patient Registration



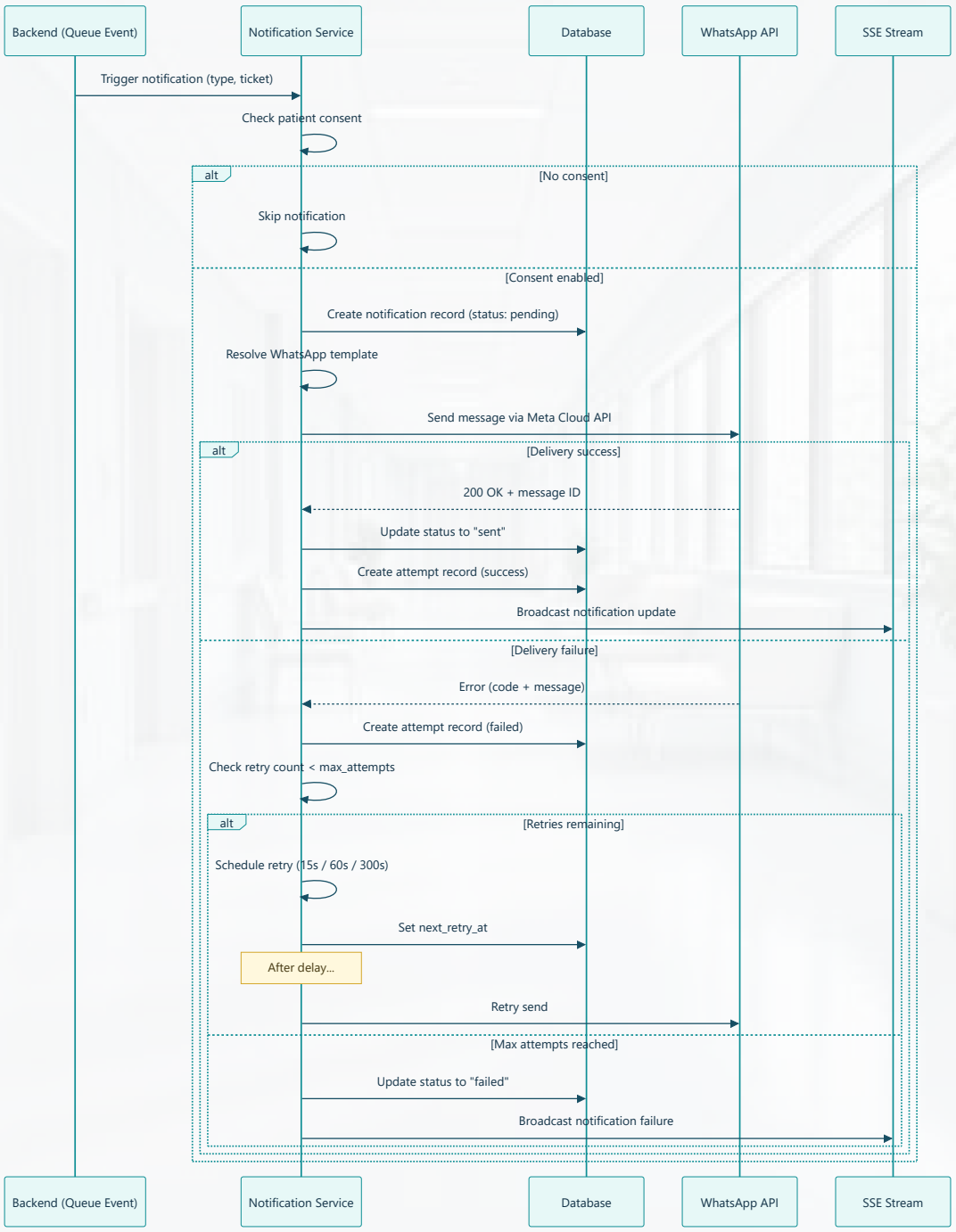
3.7.2 Sequence Diagram: Triage Assessment



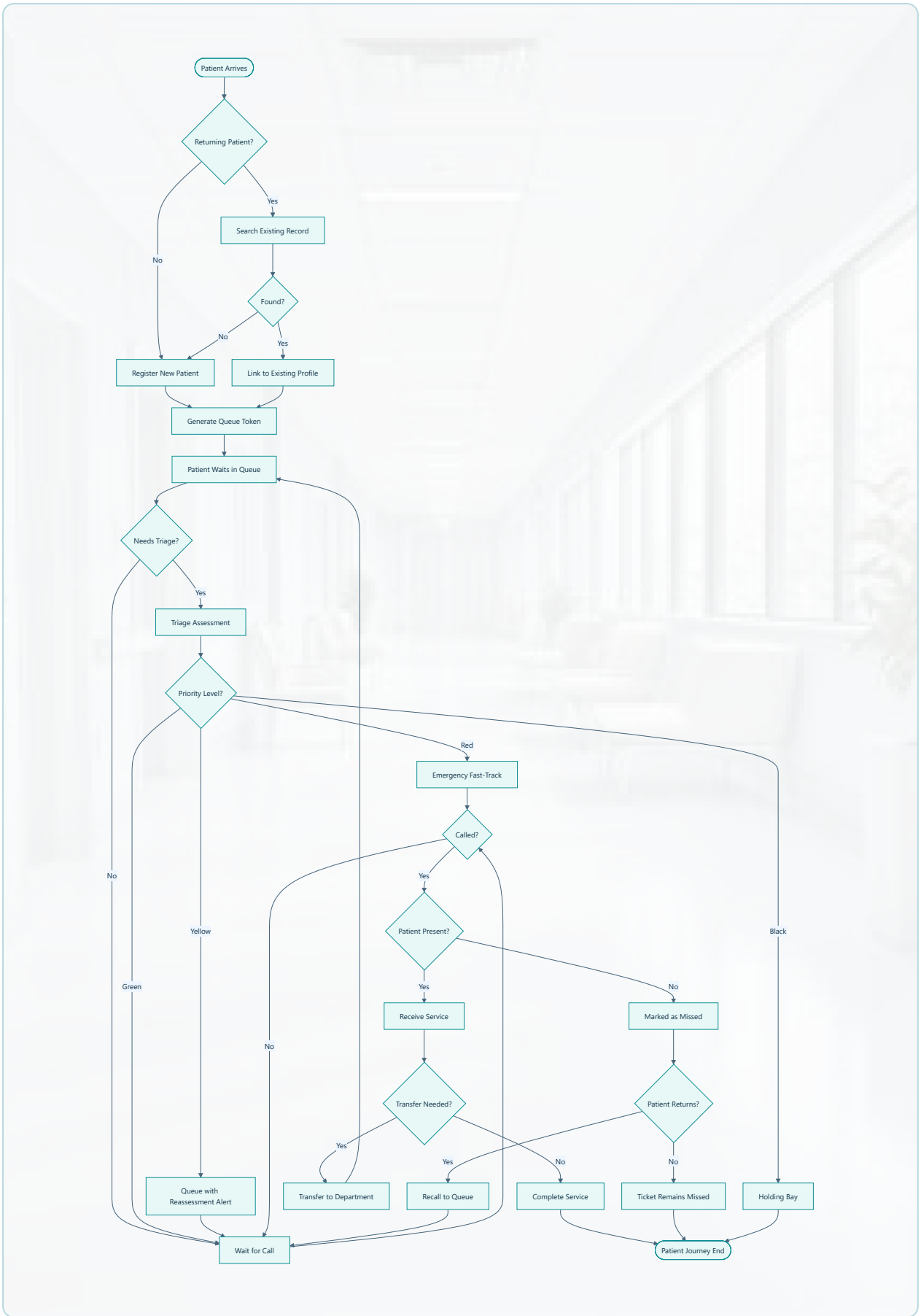
3.7.3 Sequence Diagram: Call Next Patient



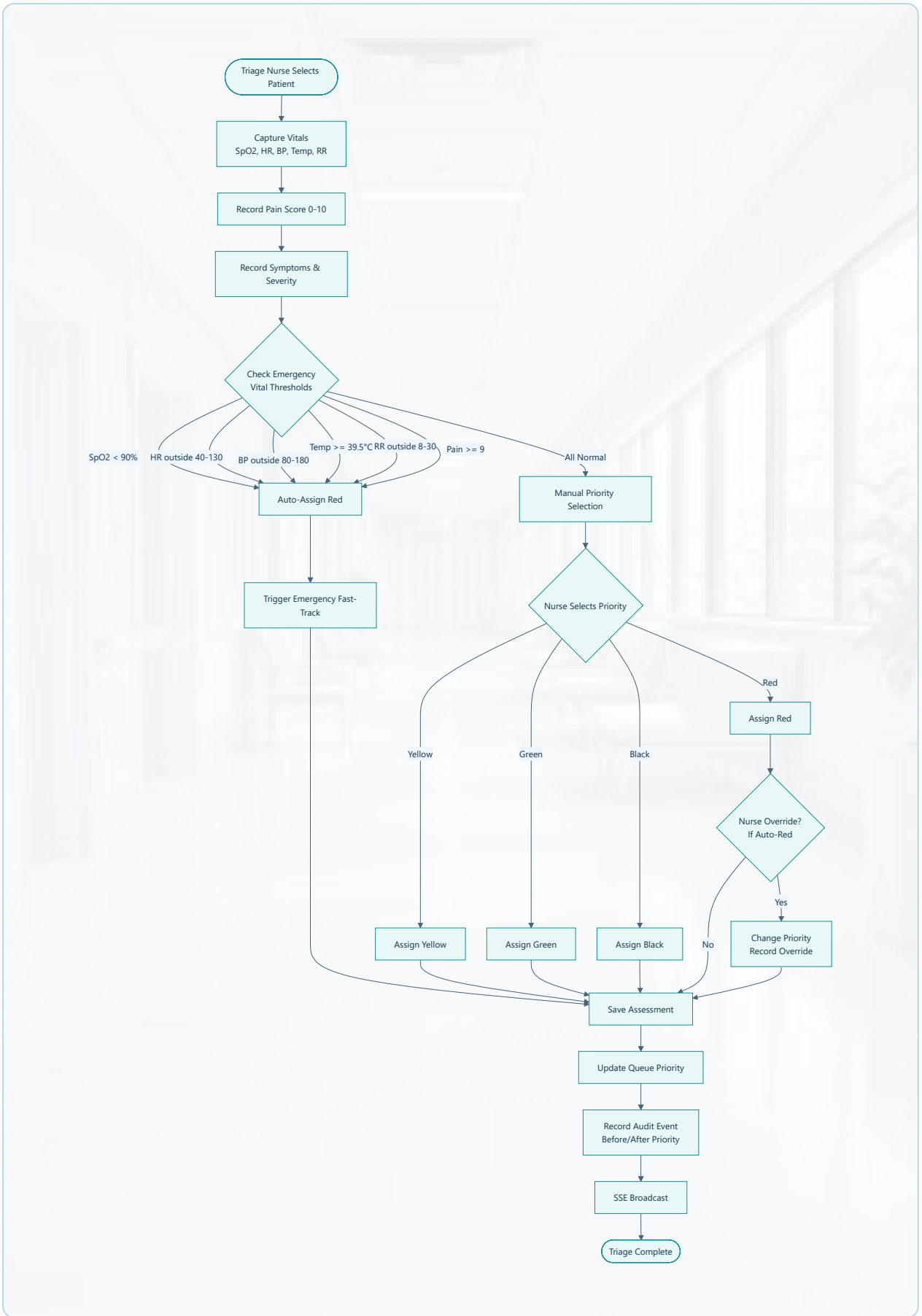
3.7.4 Sequence Diagram: Notification Dispatch with Retry



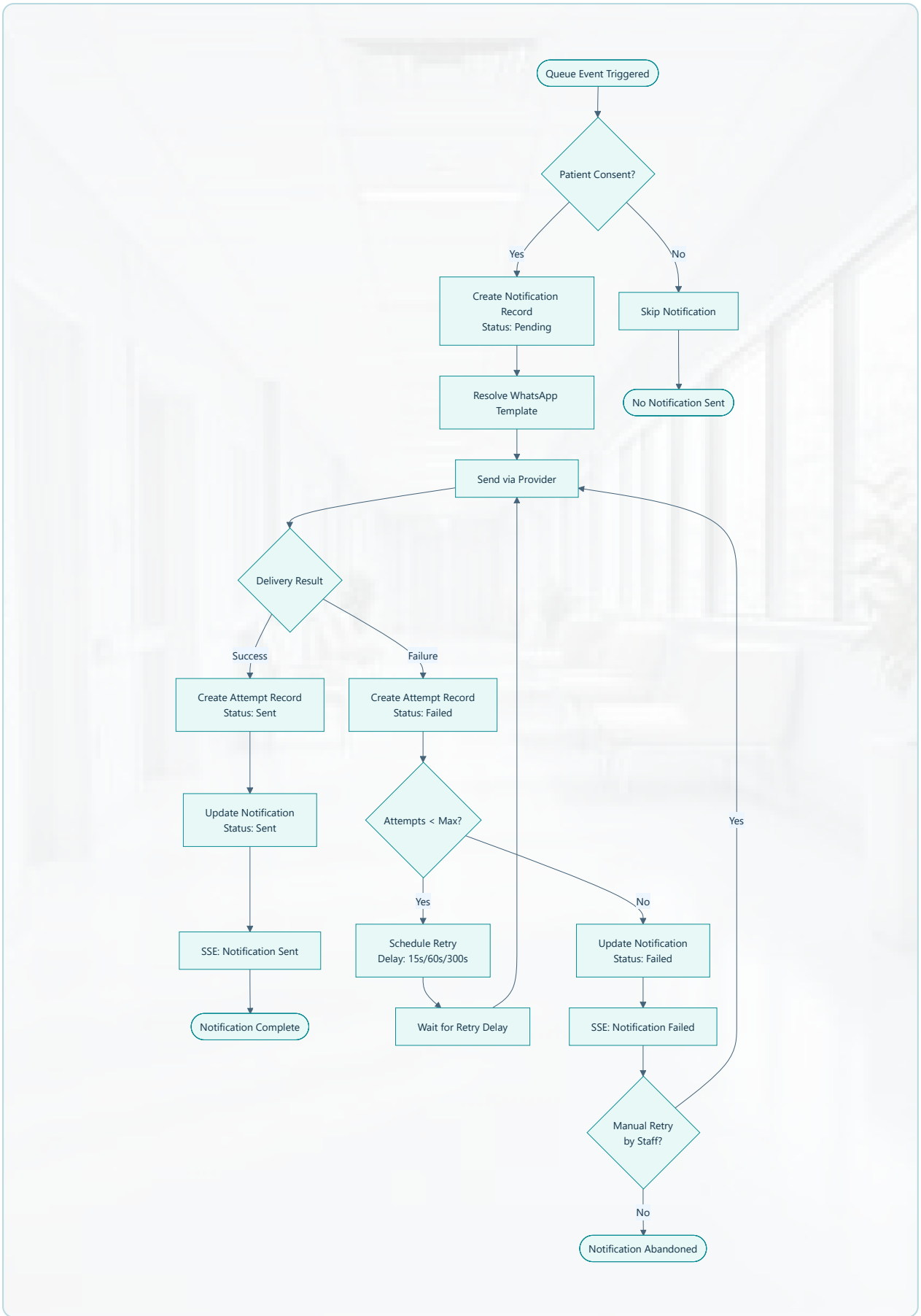
3.7.5 Activity Diagram: Patient Journey


Patient Arrives
Returning Patient?
Yes
No
Search Existing Record
Found?
No
Yes
Register New Patient
Link to Existing Profile
Generate Queue Token
Patient Waits in Queue
Needs Triage?
Yes
No
Triage Assessment
Priority Level?
Red
Yellow
Green
Black
Emergency Fast-Track
Called?
No
Yes
Patient Present?
Yes
No
Receive Service
Marked as Missed
Transfer Needed?
Patient Returns?
Yes
No
Yes
No
Queue with Reassessment Alert
Transfer to Department
Recall to Queue
Complete Service
Ticket Remains Missed
Holding Bay
Wait for Call
Patient Journey End

3.7.6 Activity Diagram: Triage Workflow


Triage Nurse Selects Patient
Capture Vitals SpO2, HR, BP, Temp, RR
Record Pain Score 0-10
Record Symptoms & Severity
Check Emergency Vital Thresholds
SpO2 < 90%
HR outside 40-130
BP outside 80-180
Temp >= 39.5°C
RR outside 8-30
Pain >= 9
All Normal
Auto-Assign Red
Manual Priority Selection
Trigger Emergency Fast-Track
Nurse Selects Priority
Yellow
Green
Black
Red
Assign Red
Nurse Override? If Auto-Red
Yes
No
Assign Yellow
Assign Green
Assign Black
Change Priority Record Override
Save Assessment
Update Queue Priority
Record Audit Event Before/After Priority
SSE Broadcast
Triage Complete

3.7.7 Activity Diagram: Notification Retry Lifecycle


Queue Event Triggered
Patient Consent?
Yes
No
Create Notification Record Status: Pending
Skip Notification
Resolve WhatsApp Template
No Notification Sent
Send via Provider
Delivery Result
Success
Failure
Create Attempt Record Status: Sent
Create Attempt Record Status: Failed
Update Notification Status: Sent
Attempts < Max?
Yes
No
SSE: Notification Sent
Schedule Retry Delay: 15s/60s/300s
Update Notification Status: Failed
Notification Complete
Wait for Retry Delay
SSE: Notification Failed
Yes
Manual Retry by Staff?
No
Notification Abandoned

3.8 User Interface Design

3.8.1 UI Design Principles

The WaitLess user interface is designed with the following principles:

1. **Medical Professional Aesthetic** — A dark teal (#0F766E) and navy colour scheme conveys clinical professionalism while reducing eye strain in hospital environments with varied lighting conditions.
2. **Glassmorphism Design** — Semi-transparent "glass" cards with backdrop blur create depth and visual hierarchy without overwhelming the user.
3. **Responsive Design** — The interface adapts to desktop monitors, tablets, and mobile phones using Tailwind CSS responsive breakpoints.
4. **Real-Time Feedback** — All queue updates are reflected instantly via Server-Sent Events, with visual indicators for connection status.
5. **Accessibility** — High contrast text, keyboard navigation, ARIA labels, and semantic HTML ensure the system is usable by staff with varying abilities.
6. **Role-Based Navigation** — Staff see only the navigation items and pages relevant to their role, reducing cognitive load.
7. **Privacy by Design** — Public displays show only token numbers, never patient names. Patient-facing pages minimise exposed personal information.

3.8.2 Colour Palette

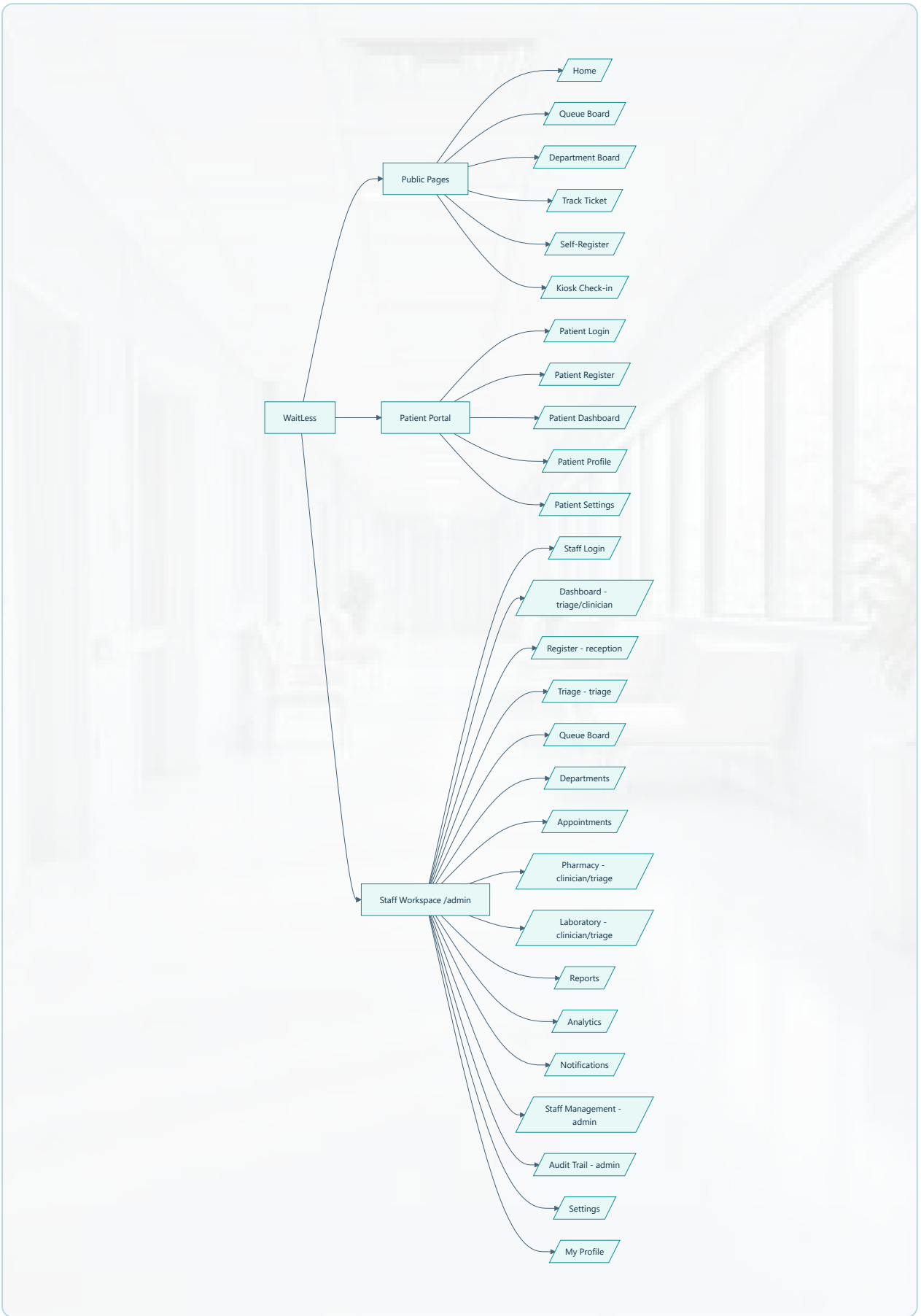
Purpose	Colour	Hex
Primary (Medical Teal)	Teal	#0F766E
Secondary (Hospital Blue)	Blue	#2563EB
Priority Red	Red	#DC2626
Priority Yellow	Amber	#F59E0B
Priority Green	Emerald	#10B981
Priority Black	Dark Grey	#1F2937
Background (Dark)	Navy/Black	#0A0F1A

Purpose	Colour	Hex
Surface (Glass)	Semi-transparent	rgba(255,255,255,0.05)
Text Primary	White	#F8FAFC
Text Muted	Slate	#94A3B8

3.8.3 Typography

Element	Font	Size	Weight
Headings	System sans-serif	1.5rem – 2.25rem	700
Body text	System sans-serif	0.875rem – 1rem	400
Labels	System sans-serif	0.75rem	500
Token numbers	Monospace	2rem – 4rem	700
Captions	System sans-serif	0.75rem	400

3.8.4 Navigation Structure


WaitLess
Public Pages
Home
Queue Board
Department Board
Track Ticket
Self-Register
Kiosk Check-in
Patient Portal
Patient Login
Patient Register
Patient Dashboard
Patient Profile
Patient Settings
Staff Workspace /admin
Staff Login
Dashboard - triage/clinician
Register - reception
Triage - triage
Queue Board
Departments
Appointments
Pharmacy - clinician/triage
Laboratory - clinician/triage
Reports
Analytics
Notifications
Staff Management - admin
Audit Trail - admin
Settings
My Profile

3.8.5 Key Page Descriptions

Landing Page (/)

- Hero section with WaitLess logo, tagline, and call-to-action buttons
- Live statistics display (patients served, current waiting, departments active)
- Feature highlights with icons
- Footer with hospital branding

Patient Registration (/admin/register)

- Multi-section form: demographics, next of kin, chief complaint, department selection
- Real-time form validation with inline error messages
- QR code scanner for returning patient lookup
- Patient category selector with visual icons
- Notification consent toggle
- On submit: ticket display with QR code, print button, and WhatsApp share

Triage Assessment (/admin/triage)

- Patient selector from waiting queue (sorted by priority)
- Vitals input form with range indicators and colour-coded warnings
- Pain score slider (0–10) with visual scale
- Symptoms and severity text areas
- Emergency vital threshold warnings (real-time as values are entered)
- Priority selection (auto-suggested based on vitals, manually overridable)
- Assessment history for previously triaged patients

Public Queue Board (/queue)

- Large-format display optimised for TV/monitor screens
- Three columns: "Now Serving", "Waiting", "Missed"
- Token numbers displayed in large monospace font
- Priority colour coding (red, yellow, green borders)
- Real-time updates via SSE (no page refresh)
- Department filter selector
- Animated transitions when tickets move between columns

Department Display Board (/department-board)

- Department-specific view (filtered by URL parameter)
- Shows only tickets for the selected department
- Larger token number display for waiting area visibility
- Real-time SSE updates
- Auto-refresh on connection loss

Staff Dashboard (/admin/dashboard)

- Live metrics cards: waiting count, in-service count, missed count, avg wait time
- Department-scoped queue table with sortable columns
- Patient action buttons: call next, mark missed, recall, transfer
- Operational alerts panel: reassessment alerts, notification failures, critical metrics
- Notification analytics with charts (delivery rate, retry trends)
- Real-time auto-refresh

Patient Tracking (/track)

- Token code input field with auto-lookup
- Progress indicator showing queue position
- Estimated wait time display
- Patients ahead count
- Department directions and current status
- Notification history timeline
- Real-time updates via SSE

Reports (/admin/reports)

- Tabbed interface: Overview, Average Wait Time, Department Performance, No-Show, Triage, WhatsApp Status
- Date range picker (from/to)
- Summary metric cards per report type
- Department breakdown tables
- Per-ticket notification correlation (no-show report)
- WhatsApp configuration checklist (status report)

Audit Trail (/admin/audit)

- Chronological list of audit events
- Filterable by action type, actor, date range
- Before/after state comparison view
- Hash chain verification indicator
- Actor details: name, role, department
- Redacted sensitive fields

3.9 Security Design

3.9.1 Authentication Model

The system implements two separate authentication flows:

Staff Authentication:

- Staff users log in with username/email and password
- Passwords are hashed using bcrypt with a cost factor of 12
- On successful login, a bearer token session is created (in-memory Map)
- Session token is included in the Authorization header for all API requests
- Sessions expire after 8 hours (configurable via `AUTH_SESSION_TTL_MS`)
- Password policy enforced: minimum 8 characters, at least 3 character groups (uppercase, lowercase, digits, special), common password rejection

Patient Authentication:

- Patient users register and log in with username/email and password
- Passwords are hashed using bcrypt
- Separate session management from staff authentication
- Patient sessions stored in localStorage with expiry tracking

3.9.2 Role-Based Access Control Matrix

Resource/Action	Admin	Reception	Triage	Clinician	Patient	Anonymous
View public queue board	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Track ticket	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Self-register / kiosk	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

Resource/Action	Admin	Reception	Triage	Clinician	Patient	Anonymous
Register patient	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Triage assessment	✓	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗
Call next patient	✓	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗
Mark missed/recall	✓	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗
Transfer patient	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
View dashboard	✓	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗
View reports	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
Manage staff	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
View audit trail	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗
Configure settings	✓	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
Prescribe medication	✓	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗
Order lab tests	✓	✗	✓	✓	✗	✗
View patient portal	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓	✗

3.9.3 Audit Trail Design

The audit trail provides a tamper-evident record of all system actions:

1. **Append-Only Storage** — Audit events are written to the `audit_events` table (MySQL) or `audit-events.jsonl` file. No update or delete operations are supported.
2. **SHA-256 Hash Chaining** — Each audit event includes:
   - `previous_hash`: The `event_hash` of the preceding event
   - `event_hash`: SHA-256 hash of the event's content + `previous_hash`

   This creates a cryptographic chain where modifying any event invalidates all subsequent hashes.
3. **Sensitive Data Redaction** — Passwords, session tokens, and other sensitive fields are redacted in the `before_state` and `after_state` JSON before hashing.
4. **Actor Attribution** — Every event records the actor's ID, name, role, and department, providing full accountability.

5. **Tracked Actions** — Login, staff creation, profile updates, ticket creation, triage assessment, priority changes, status updates, recalls, transfers, prescription and test order events, arrival confirmation, and notification retries.

3.9.4 Privacy Measures

Measure	Implementation
Anonymous public displays	Queue board and department board show only token numbers, never patient names
Notification consent	Patients explicitly opt in to WhatsApp notifications during registration
Patient tracking privacy	Tracking page requires only a token code; no authentication needed, but no personal data is displayed
Audit redaction	Sensitive fields are redacted before storage in audit events
Department scoping	Non-admin staff see only their department's data in dashboards, tickets, and notifications

3.10 Summary

This chapter has presented a comprehensive system analysis and design for the WaitLess Digital Queue Management System. The requirements analysis identified 83 functional requirements across 21 modules, supplemented by 15 non-functional requirements and stakeholder-specific user requirements. Use case diagrams and detailed descriptions model the key interactions between actors and the system. The system architecture was defined as a layered client-server design with React frontend, Node.js backend, dual-mode data storage, and WhatsApp Cloud API integration. The data design section provided a complete entity-relationship diagram, data dictionary, and data flow diagrams. Process design was illustrated through sequence and activity diagrams for critical system flows. The user interface design established the visual language, navigation structure, and page descriptions. Finally, the security design detailed the authentication model, role-based access control, audit trail, and privacy measures.

The next chapter, Chapter 4: Implementation, details how this design was realised in code, including the technology stack, module implementations, and deployment configuration.